Bite Me

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Characters:	Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail), Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Hyacine (Honkai: Star Rail), Aglaea (Honkai: Star Rail), Castorice (Honkai: Star Rail), Anaxa (Honkai: Star Rail), Cipher (Honkai: Star Rail)
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Bite Me

by coconutMochi

Summary

"…Pull yourself together," Mydei muttered, hands on Phainon's shoulders, trying to gently, pry the other Alpha off.

Phainon *whined.* His grip tightened as he nuzzled further in to his chest, letting out another whine like this was *exactly* where he wanted to be.

And Mydei?

Mydei *panicked.*

Red crystals were growing around the arena, and around them. He should probably get them under control, but—

By Nikador's name—

What had he done.

Or where Alpha Mydei accidentally marks Phainon during a spar.

Notes

Hello there!

This is something for my friend Ela, they brought this idea onto my head so that's how this came into light. Lmao

It was originally supposed to be a one shot but I got carried away now it has more stuff lol.

Basically the promt was - Alpha x Alpha with submissive Phainon, where Mydei accidentally bites Phainon during a spar. But I got carried away with it—

Do read the tags for warnings if anything, this is something short and sweet for fellow A/B/O enjoyers!

Enjoy.

Chapter 1: Submit

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It all started with a small spar.

Mydei met Phainon on a morning, completely normal, he asked for a sparring session. And of course, Phainon obliged, excited as they both headed toward the training area.

Eventually, they emptied the place; it was just the two of them. People found it too intimidating once the two strong Alphas started throwing punches at each other. The air around them was thick —others couldn't breathe in it. So, they were left alone.

When it all started, Mydei had been winning.
He had the upper hand. Phainon was using a wooden sword like a fool, shoving that thing toward Mydei. And, as you'd guess, the Strife's demigod didn't need much effort—the wooden sword broke into shreds with one punch as Phainon tried to dodge.

Mydei huffed, more confident now, at the other's stupid face, he was looking at the broken sword like it had personally offended him.

"Come on now," Mydei started, "Draw Dawnmaker, *Deliverer*." He said it in a tone almost sly. "Fighting a demigod with a wooden sword? How foolish," he laughed, lunging at the other, throwing in another attack, *forcing* Phainon to draw the real blade.

To his satisfaction, the other Alpha did.
Dawnmaker was summoned instantly to block Mydei's attack, just as it was about to graze his cheek. Both of them were pushed back.

"Just like that," Mydei said, satisfied.

Phainon shook his head. "You know, it's only fair if I didn't use my sword either," he said, though he knew Mydei's strength, and that without his sword, he was at a disadvantage. Not that he'd admit it out loud.

"Come on now, you're supposed to defeat me one day, remember?" Mydei said, so nonchalant. "And how will you face me as I am—Strife itself?"

He charged in again, continuing his attacks, giving Phainon no time to even think of dodging. And so, things escalated from there.

They were fighting, with Mydei holding the upper hand.

…Well, in the beginning.

There *might've* been a minor miscalculation. On Mydei's end, today. He got a *tiny* bit clumsy.

Like—

It was all going fine. He'd dodged a swing, landed a solid kick, even caught Phainon off-balance once and *swept the bastard's legs*. Phainon had hit the dirt laughing, Dawnmaker barely missing his own foot.

"You're in high spirits today, Mydeimos," Phainon had teased, brushing mud off his cheek.

"Shut up and fight," Mydei muttered, already charging again.

Now?

Now *he* was pinned to the ground. Chest heaving. Sweat dripping into his eye. Dawnmaker's hilt dug into his left wrist like a warning, while Phainon's wrist pressed against his throat, firm and steady. The other's full weight was on Mydei's hips, pinning him down.

Their faces were so close, too close just *inches* apart, that Mydei could feel the other's breath against his face.

Phainon grinned, loose and cocky, white hair falling in his face. "Do you yield?"

Mydei bared his teeth.

"Never."

It wasn't just pride. It was the way Phainon was *looking* at him. Smug, flushed, glowing under the training ground sky like he knew he had him. Like he'd *win.*

And no. That wouldn't do.

Mydei's gaze flicked to the black leather choker hanging half-torn from Phainon's neck.

He'd caught it mid-tumble earlier. Didn't mean to. Mostly. But he hadn't exactly let it go, either. It dangled loose now, showing the edge, and most of the golden sun tattoo underneath.

Mydei smirked, lips twitching.

There.

His way out.

Both of them never shied away from cheating. And what he was planning wasn't cheating, per se—just a dirty trick. And this would be no different. Both of them had their own wits and tricks when it came to their little challenges. Plus kremnoan worriers are known to be savages during battles, so this will be not that far off for him.

And so he tried to feel his hands.

His left arm? It was still stuck.

But his right arm? Nearly free. He flexed his fingers, shifting it slightly, and, his wrist slipped from Phainon's grip.

Before Phainon could react, Mydei reached up—and yanked the rest of the choker clean off.

Phainon flinched.

That was the crack he needed.

Mydei lunged forward and **bit** him—right over the sun tattoo.

It was sharp and deep. Not enough to hurt badly, but enough to draw blood.

Phainon's body arched in surprise, a startled, raw sound ripping from his throat. The pressure on Mydei's wrists loosened.

Mydei shoved him off hard, rolling up into a seated position, spitting the taste of blood from his mouth.

He braced for a hit or comeback. Something stupid like, *'Really? Teeth?'* Or a smug, *'Finally using your mouth for something useful?'*.

But unlike he expected non came, only silence.

And for too long, There were no insults. No flinging Dawnmaker at his face. Not even giggling.

"…Was the Great Deliverer silenced by a mere bite?" he laughed, finally turning to face the man.

But when his eyes caught the other, Phainon was still lying on his side, haven't recovered from the push, eyes wide, with fingers hovering over the bite mark. Breathing shallow. Mouth shut. Not making any effort to stand or even move.

The weird part wasn't that he was still and quiet.

It was his *eyes.*

They weren't blue.

They were *gold*. Bright, glazed over, and staring past Mydei, like he wasn't even there.

Mydei squinted. "HKS?"

That usually worked. It usually snapped him out of his head, angered him, provoked a reaction. But instead of replying, Phainon's dazed eyes focused on him.

And something in Mydei's gut turned at the way the other was looking at him.

Before he could even process it, or prepare another comeback.

Phainon *crawled.*

Hah… did he really hit his head that hard when Phainon pinned him before? had his healing dulled that much? Because *why* was the destined deliverer of Okhema crawling toward him.

On his hands and knees.

Crawling.

Across the dirt.

Right toward him.

Mydei blinked once.

Then again.

Mydei found himself inching back, instinctively trying to put distance between them, between whatever it was Phainon was trying to do. Fear? No. There was no word for fear in the kremnoen language. It was something else entirely. The sheer aftershock of processing the sight of the other approaching him like that.

To his luck and horrible *horrible* fate, his back hit the weapon rack behind him, halting him cold.

“Hey—”

Phainon paid him no mind. He just kept moving. Climbing onto him, settling into his lap without a word. Just… settled there. Legs folded to the side, arms looping loosely around his waist. He pressed his cheek against Mydei’s bare chest, still breathing heavy but… calm.

“Deliverer.”

He felt the others weight, heat, breathe just everything.

“Phainon”

Nothing.

“…Pull yourself together,” Mydei said, hands on his shoulders, trying—gently, forcefully—to pry him off.

Phainon *whined.*

It was a soft, pathetic noise that made something in Mydei’s spine curl.

Phainon’s grip tightened as he nuzzled further in, letting out another whine like this was *exactly* where he wanted to be.

And Mydei?

Mydei *panicked.*

Red crystals were growing around the arena, and around them. He should probably get them under control, but—

By Nikador’s name—

What the fuck.

Why was his equal, his rival, and the very person he’d told his sole weakness to, rubbing his cheek into his chest?

Mydei found one of his hands reaching toward Phainon, fingers threading through white hair before gripping it, pulling gently, making the other tilt his head up from where it had been tucked against

his chest.

He meant to say something.

But the words caught in his throat.

Phainon's cheek still rested against his chest, stubbornly unmoved, yet his eyes—gold, with barely a flicker of blue left—were looking up at him. Confused, flushed but content. Adoration shimmered through the haze, soft and disarming, despite the unkind grip Mydei still had on his hair.

Mydei's face burned. His hand let go, gaze breaking away. His heartbeat was… not normal.

And Phainon—delirious, oblivious—just sighed softly… and melted further into his chest, as if the world outside didn't exist.

Calming himself, Mydei dared a glance down at the white-haired Alpha curled against him. Clinging like they hadn't been sparring minutes ago. Like they hadn't just been at each other's throats minutes ago.

"…What did I do?" he muttered to himself, horrified.

And *Titans*, he hears *purring*.

...

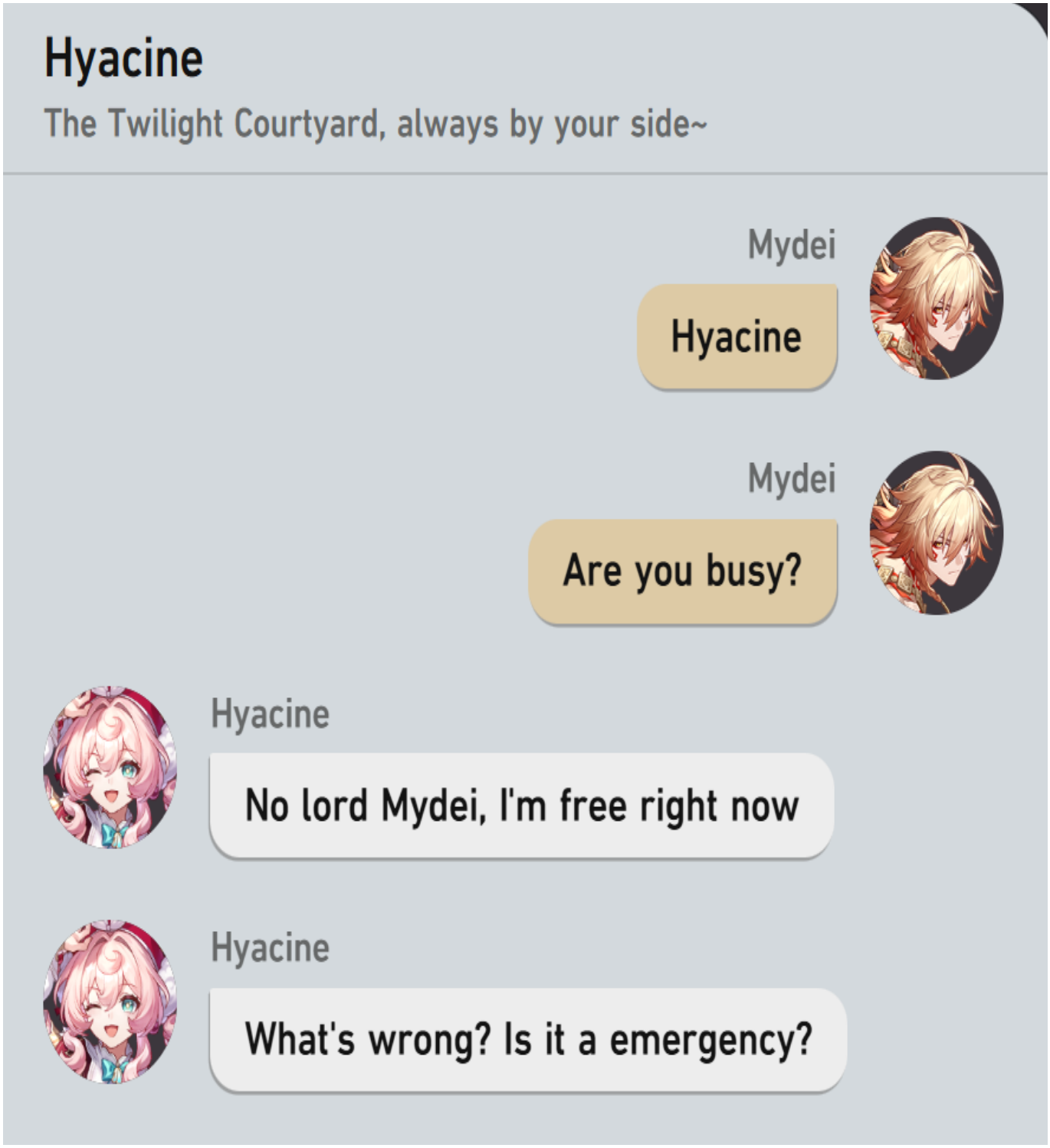
Hyacine had just finished wrapping a patient's shoulder when her teleslate buzzed.

The senders name blinked at the front.

It read Mydeimos.

She blinked. Mydei never messaged her first.

Unless.

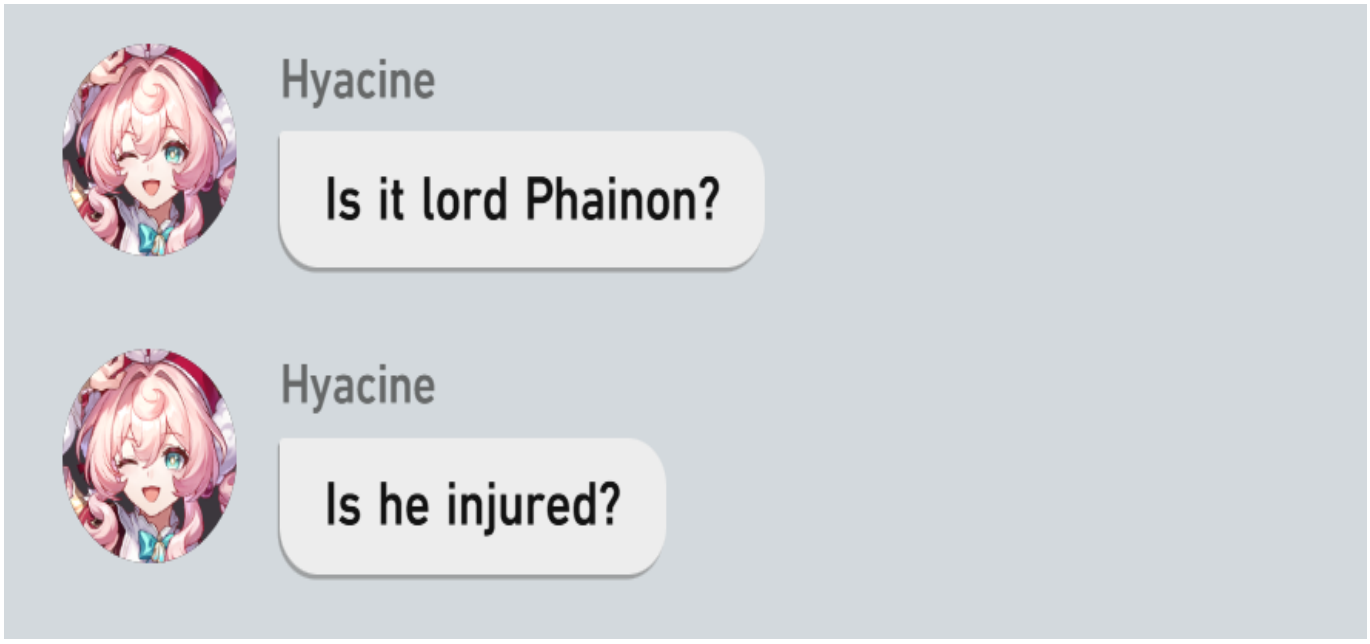


She saw typing then a pause.

To typing again.

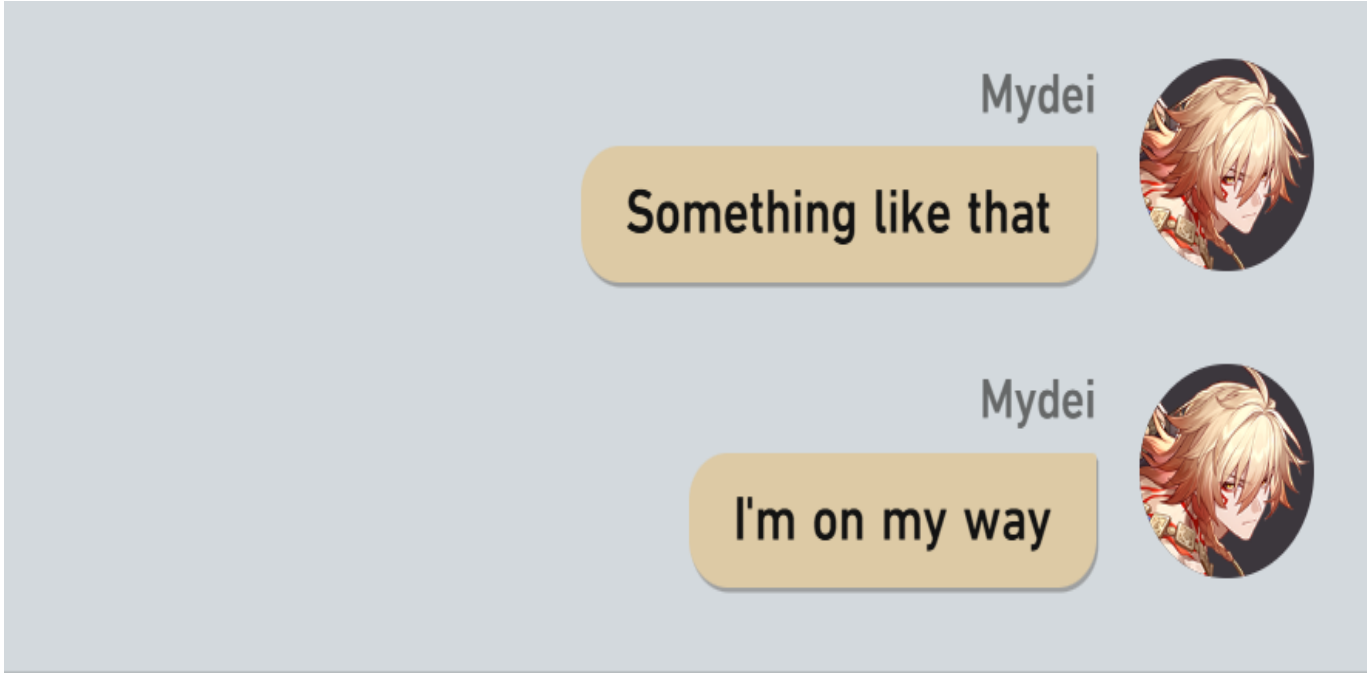


Her eyes narrowed into a frown.



There was another pause a bit longer this time.

Then



...

And that's how they ended up here, In Twilight Courtyard. On a bed. With a Phainon who's refusing to let go.

It had been mortifying carrying the alpha across the city like a toddler. Mydei had to assure the worried citizens that their 'Beloved Deliverer' was just injured and not... well. Whatever else they might've assumed.

He sighs now, arms full of a clingy, oversized alpha.

After explaining everything, Aglaea, who likely saw or heard everything through her threads, had seated herself in the infirmary with her chin perched in her hands, visibly thinking. Thoughtful. Knowing.

Hyacine, on the other hand, was struggling to examine the bite mark. Phainon kept trying to hide his neck, nuzzling stubbornly into Mydei's shoulder, refusing to be touched.

The moment her fingers accidentally brushed his hand, Phainon growled low. Then whimpered out an apologetic whine.

Hyacine groaned under her breath, frustrated.

"So… anything?" Mydei asked, adjusting his grip on the massive alpha purring in his lap him.

"Well," Hyacine said, a bit flushed, "Um-" she looked around trying to word it out and said.

"…it looks like you claimed him."

A chunk red crystals bursted through the ceiling as his soul evacuates his body for a second.

No one commented about the crystal.

Hyacine sits beside the bed and folds her arms with the calm of a person who has *absolutely no idea* what to say that'll make the situation better "Good news or bad news?"

"Good first," he says grimly.

"The mark is temporary. It'll fade in a day or two, and shouldn't have lasting effects."

He exhales.

"…And the bad?"

"You accidentally dragged him into alpha subspace… and," omega healer says hesitating, clearly weighing the words.

Mydei's patience snapped. "And what."

Aglaea, who'd been quiet until now finally spoke. She always sounded sensitive when it came to the topic of anything regarding the Deliverer, but Mydei didn't have the bandwidth to unpack that particular favoritism right now.

"It's a wonder why his alpha is clingy toward you," she said flatly. "If it were any other alpha, it might've ended in bloodshed."

Mydei blinked. He wasn't particularly educated on secondary gender dynamics, never had the time or need to be. He was a warrior. And a prince. He didn't get to empathize with things like this.

"But… he's an alpha," he said, stupidly. Because that was obvious.

"That he is," Aglaea replied, unbothered. "Which is why it's shocking."

"What do you mean?"

"His alpha should be biting your head off for claiming him. Instead…" She gestured to Phainon on his lap, still purring like a satisfied cat. "He's submitting to you."

Oh

Submit

wait

Submit?

The word hit Mydei like a charging Doromas as another crystal popped behind the bed. This time it made Hyacine flinch a bit.

He opened his mouth. And closed. Opened again. And closed. His scent soured slightly with confusion.

To that Phainon reacted immediately. His distress bloomed in tandem, nosing at Mydei's neck, hands making their way to grip on to Mydei's shouldes so he can move more freely, all while trying to scent him back to calm.

It worked. Which was… more concerning.

The other two awkwardly cleared their throats.

"Ahem. Anyway. What's done is done," Aglaea declared, brushing nonexistent dust from her dress standing up. "I have important matters to attend to, and I suppose the punishment for both of you for your recklessness is being served as we speak. I won't tack on more." Her eyes narrowed. "Take care of him."

And so she left without another word.

Mydei let out the breath he'd been holding.

Phainon's scent curled around him. Warm, calm, grounding. But even that couldn't quiet the internal screaming.

"I'll pay for the ceiling" he finally said, "and the wall"

Hyacine gave him a sympathetic look. That said 'it was fine' before comforting him. "I'm sure you were unaware, Lord Mydei," she said gently. Not about the wall or the ceiling just the situation "I can sedate him until he's normal, if you're uncomfortable."

"No," Mydei said, too quickly.

Hyacine smiled faintly, then outlined what little was known. Submissive alphas were rare. There wasn't much research on how to care for one, especially not one stuck in subspace. Her only recommendation: take him home and let him rest. She healed what wounds she could, despite Phainon reflexively trying to nip at her fingers for touching him. He looked deeply confused by his own behavior—and guilty, every time he lashed out.

Mydei sighed. Of course the other alpha was new to this too.

They left the infirmary shortly after.

"Walk, Deliverer," Mydei said, flatly. No way was he explaining this mess to passersby. No way was he carrying him again, not with rumors already no doubt bubbling.

Phainon blinked up at him like a kicked puppy and stood obediently.

Mydei groaned. "Don't do that."

Phainon tilted his head.

"Don't listen to what I say so easily, you idiot," he muttered, trying to preserve the last shreds of the other alpha's dignity. Because surely…surely—Phainon would be mortified once this haze wore off.

They were almost to the outside the courtyard when Phainon reached out, grabbing Mydei's arm.

And Mydei turned.

Phainon looked at him like he wanted to hold hands. His eyes were wide-eyed and hopeful, staring at his arm then to his face.

Mydei instinctively flinched, and Phainon immediately withdrew his hands and looked down, fidgeting with his fingers. Ashamed.

Really?

He was trying to save the other's pride here, and this is what he get?

Mydei dragged a frustrated hand over his face before sighing and stabbing his own hand forward. He grasped Phainon's and dragged him along without looking back. If he looked, he'd see those impossibly big bright gold-and-blue eyes again.

They reached Mydei's quarters in silence ignoring all the curious glances and whispers. He then opened the door, and stormed inside.

Still holding Phainon's hand.

...

Mydei lets out a tired sigh as he drags both of them into his kitchen.

Even though he's bone-deep exhausted from everything that happened today, they still needed to eat. Even if he didn't, Phainon would surely appreciate food.

He makes Phainon sit on the chair near the counter while the other Alpha dumbly stares at the action, like a lost puppy. And just as he's about to let go, Phainon makes a noise. Because of course he does.

They haven't detached from each other since the fateful bite incident. So yeah, this will be hard. Even though Mydei's patience is wearing thin—mostly because of the shock he went through in the past few quints, he just has to roll with it. Because, yes, it *was* kind of his fault.

So Mydei ever-so-kindly snaps his hand free, ignoring the other's whines. Because by Strife's name, the whining. That is the last sound he ever imagined hearing from the other's mouth. He hadn't uttered a single word, it was all just noises. Again it was the last thing Mydei imagined when he asked for a sparring session this morning. Not that he absolutely hated it(his own alpha was annoyingly loving whatever was going on here which made Mydei somewhat embarrassed) and He does enjoy the other's attention. It's that everything about this catches him off guard, and he does not like that.

He hurries to make them something. He had some leftover bater from today's breakfast—golden honey cakes.

"Pancakes for dinner," he mutters, disappointed. But his brain can't muster the energy to make anything else right now. So he makes a few. He can feel eyes drilling into his back, examining

every movement, but he ignores it and proceeds to plate them both.

He sits across from Phainon, much to the clingy Alpha's disappointment.

He'll live, Mydei thinks.

And starts eating. He's halfway through his plate when he notices the other hasn't touched his. He's just staring.

Titans, you can see other's imaginary dog ears droop.

And Mydei curses. He finishes his plate quickly before moving to sit beside Phainon, picking up a fork and feeding him.

This is bizarre. It's like he's handling a overgrown pup. The other immediately brightens, biting every bite Mydei gives him, happily.

Something in Mydei's chest twists at these small things. This was new to him, to them, being this close to the other. Of course, Phainon would always drag Mydei off to baths, dinners, like it was normal. But he knows how closed off the other is at the same time. To see him *so* out of his normal zone feels... odd. But comforting.

And Mydei can't deny the tension between them.

They were equals—and Alphas. So it was normal for them to be competing with each other, right? Phainon would always respect Mydei's space. He never crossed the line. Never made either of them uncomfortable—well, ignoring what happened today. But that was... semi-conscious.

He looks at Phainon, who takes another bite from the fork he offers, happily smiling. Mydei would've smiled too, if it weren't for that haze clouding the other's eyes.

This was Phainon's Alpha, Mydei tells himself. Not entirely *Phainon*. He needs the other's consciousness too.

Aglaea's words rang in his ears,

'He's submitting to you.'

That's... the problem.

When they spar, it doesn't end until one of them yields. And most of the time, they don't—until one can't stand anymore. Heck, they were at each other's throats for ten days. So yes, they're both stubborn Alphas.

To think that an Alpha like that gave up so easily to him... This, this is something else.

He needs to talk to Phainon about all of this. Really talk. He will apologize—but not now. They need to sort out these feelings. Right now, the other will just whine, thinking he's been rejected.

So that's a talk for later.

Right now, he'll focus on taking care of him.

Chapter End Notes

My dearest Mydeimos… guess why his Alpha is submitting to you—come on lad it's obvious 🫵

And honorable mention:

Mydei: Hyacine there's a emergency

Hyacine: Is it lord Phainon again?

I'd love Hyacine's a worrywart towards the heirs and like to imagine Mydei would rarely ask for her help unless it's something regarding Phainon and her immediate reply is "IS PHAINON OKEY?"

I'm all for fluff and crack these days, wanting to lay low on angst department since heh the game it self is full filing that very well thank you.

Anyways Thank you for reading!

Chapter 2: Wildest Dreams

Chapter Summary

Mydei gets a bit too carried away scenting a certain submissive Alpha.

Chapter Notes

So um…*scratches head*

Content Warning ⚠️ - (Extreme Scenting) Unhinged and Possessive behavior

Oh who am I kidding, you can't just read a A/B/O fic and not expect unhinged ◡̈

Lmao

Anyway Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Mydei let his hand dip into the water, checking the temperature. They should've just gone to the private baths instead of being here. Yet here they were, in Mydei's own bath, which he rarely used, now filled with hot, comfortable water.

But considering the chances of running into someone he knows or anyone was best avoided. For both his and Phainon's sake. Mydei sighed as he took his hand away from the bath.

His other hand, however, was occupied.

Occupied with keeping a certain Alpha busy.

Mydei glared at the white haired Alpha beside him, who was currently playing with his right hand. Intertwining fingers, tracing knuckles, caressing each line like he'd never seen Mydei's bare hands before.

Infuriating, Mydei thought. He was handling a pup. That much he had realized now. His brain just couldn't process it before. Because never had he imagined the side of the one he considered his equal, an Alpha of great strength, to be so… carefree? Unguarded? Completely bare? He doesn't even know. And all this *in front of him* of all people. It was all too shocking, but for now it's just something he'll have to deal with.

They were in Mydei's bath. Their armor off. All the heavy clothing too—well, Phainon's heavy clothing. Mydei swears there were too many straps on this man. He had to uncover all of them one by one while they stripped. Stripped to just their undergarments.

As soon as his gauntlets were off, and so Phainon found a new hobby, examining Mydei's bare hands like it was one of the the most deep buried mysteries of Amphoreus.

Mydei shook his head and exhaled a deep sigh, then wordlessly raised the hand in the other's grasp. Just high enough to align with the other's face. He let it hover for a bit, and as Phainon glanced up, curious, Mydei just grabbed the poor alpha's face and shoved him into the water, completely nonchalant. The other landed face first, butt up, knees in the bath before scrambling upright, coughing out water, grabbing the pools's edge for support as he heaved and pouted toward Mydei. Face red.

Mydei found himself smiling. For the first time.

Now *that* was a reaction he had recognized—or rather, expected. It made Mydei relax, somewhat. That it wasn't just some shapeshifter in disguise as his Phainon. So he laughed—laughed his worries away. Laughed like this wasn't all a cruel joke shoved in his face just to twist with his heart.

Phainon tilted his head, confused as to why the other was laughing. But since Mydei was smiling, Phainon decided to smile too as he leaned over the bath's edge, resting his head on his hands.

And just like that, some tension between the two eased up. Mydei cleaned both of them, Phainon obviously clinging to him like a lifeline. After they were freshened up, well not fully, but somewhat dressed in leisure chitons, Mydei led them toward his bedroom.

Where his bed was.

With one bed.

A bed big enough for two adults.

And Mydei stopped dead in his tracks.

Phainon knocked his nose into the back of the other's head, not expecting the abrupt stop. He made a confused noise and looked, rubbing his sore nose. Mydei stood there, completely still, looking fine but a storm clearly running through his mind. Spiraling over sharing a bed for the first time.

So Phainon, most thoughtful Alpha of the moment, stepped in front of Mydei, grabbed his face, and squished his cheeks to get his attention. Mydei's thoughts cleared instantly to the sight of Phainon, just inches away, holding his face.

His gaze dropped, traitorous eyes scanning the other's lips. Because that's where a normal person would look if they had a big fat crush—if they were inches apart, breath fanning across their faces. One yank and those lips would be on his—

But Mydei's instinct and rational mind weren't on the same page to his own disappointment, as his hand pushed the other away instead of following through with… whatever fantasy he just had.

The other Alpha let himself be pushed, knees hitting the bed's edge, making him sit. He looked up at Mydei.

And Mydei blinked. His eyes traveled over the man sitting on his bed. This may look like the most scandalous situation to anyone who barged in at this moment—two half-naked, well respected,

strong healthy Alphas, staring at each other hungrily, eyes trailing over one another like it was a feast.

Mydei's gaze dropped to the exposed thigh under the white chiton that did a very poor job covering them. Then to the mark on the other's neck—where Mydei's Alpha pride secretly rests (he'll never admit it out loud). Then to Phainon's hazy gold eyes, with just a small hint of blue left, reminding him this wasn't entirely Phainon. But he could also feel the same hungry gaze directed at his own exposed chest.

Trying to push whatever his primal desire wanted, Mydei manifested all his remaining willpower to try and be the responsible one.

So he cleared his throat, arms crossing over his chest, a bit self-conscious under the other's gaze.

"You take that side," he said, pointing to the right side of the bed. "This side is mine." He glared at the other, who was currently sitting on his side.

Phainon blinked. Dumbly. Then scrambled, wordlessly, toward the right side, settling obediently into place and smiling at Mydei.

Mydei rolled his eyes at the behavior before settling onto his side, tossing the comforter aside.

The moment he hit the mattress, he could feel himself melt into it. Exhausted. Mentally and physically.

Just as his eyes were about to shut down for the day, he felt a small tug from behind.

And Mydei felt a vein almost pop.

really now?

Yet he stayed still. Pretending to sleep, and he felt a weight behind him shift, not too close, surprisingly. *Was Phainon's Alpha finally learning some manners?* His tired brain joked. Too exhausted to even scold him, Mydei let the other do whatever.

Only when he felt the other's breathing even out did he finally turn back. Phainon was sleeping on his side, facing him, a hand half reached out like it had stopped mid reach.

It made Mydei almost feel guilty for not holding it.

He turned fully, watching him.

Phainon looked peaceful.

His white hair was a mess. His lashes brushed against his cheeks, eyes closed, breathing soft. The usual tension in his features had vanished and he looked young, almost gentle like this.

Mydei's gaze drifted to the mark on his neck again. He reached for it unconsciously…then stopped, afraid he'd wake him. He let his hand drop and rested his eyes on Phainon's face again, watching the peaceful expression. And so he rested his eyes like that, feeling a surprising warmth bloom in his chest.

…

Mydei wakes up with a gasp. He was woken by the sharp pain on his back. As a warrior, his immediate response was alarm, his hands went to grip the threat that was causing him harm.

As he was about to tear the weight and pain or whatever it was off him, he heard a barely audible whimper, and he snapped his eyes open.

It took a second to process and fully grasp the situation as his sleep-alarmed mind cleared.

He was in his room.

And he remembered going to sleep with Phainon.

But he doesn't remember what caused this position.

He was now on his other side with Phainon under his chin, who was breathing heavily with a arm that had a death grip on his back. He could feel the stinging pain of the other's nails piercing through his skin. And the air around the room smelled like something charred, overripe and with a fading hint of golden musk that screamed anguish.

Confused further, he looked down at Phainon, still asleep with his eyes tightly shut, but nothing in his face said calm. He looked distressed, a color painted across his face that Mydei could recognize as a familiar feeling of a nightmare. The scent was highlighting *his* distress.

Of course, Mydei himself wasn't a stranger to nightmares, so he isn't surprised the other was the same. Phainon, who never truly elaborated about his childhood other than losing his companions and kin—he assumed it must've been bad.

He gently nudged the other, trying to wake him up. The other only tightened the grip, making Mydei hiss a bit. He was sure there'd be marks on his back. And Mydei was genuinely too tired to deal with this right now. He needed sleep. They both did. And his mind wasn't exactly patient right now.

And just like that his own hazy, tired mind took over. He rolled them over, pushing Phainon flat on his back with both hands on the other's shoulders, hovering over him.

His mind provided only one solution right now. So he buried his nose deep into the other's neck, inhaling deeply—taking in the full smell of citrus and golden musk. It was almost overtaken by the charred, burnt scent but still there. And he let his nose wander, exploring Phainon's pale skin, nuzzling in to tracing the curve of his shoulder.

Mydei lets his own scent of smoked sandalwood with a hint of red peppercorn take over, trying to dominate the other's charred and distressed scent, scenting him openly, trying to wake the other up.

Phainon through the process, somewhat loosened the death grip he had on his back, and makes a quiet noise.

Which meant it was working.

Mydei found himself purring a bit with satisfaction. He could feel the other reveal his neck more, baring it, completely giving in to his touch—Mydei's lips parted against the neck, mouthing at the skin just above the bite mark. Then dragging his tongue over to the healing mark.

And Phainon moaned, hands sliding up from Mydei's back to grip his hair. Something inside Mydei buzzed in pride.

The scent of charred, burnt distress dulled back to its normalcy while both of their scents mixed, making Mydei more and more delirious. He found himself unable to resist the sweet smell of blossoming citrus as his nose was suddenly attacked with its full glory. He heard a soft gasp as his tongue dragged with more pressure over the sun tattoo—to almost sucking over it like hungry animal, the white haired alpha had moaned again and his grip on Mydei's hair trembling—too sensitive to the touch there, his body arched up into him, chest brushing against his own, skin against skin.

Mydei wanted. *Titans*, he wanted more.

"So good for me," He praised, kissing his mark. A broken whine answered, one that was needier.

Smirking against the skin, Mydei let's mouth traveled higher, bolder now, right under the other's jaw, leaving a soft trail of wet kisses while his nose ghosted over. He felt hot—too hot, and eventually found his way to the other's ear, licking the skin under it teasingly. That was rewarded with another eager whine.

"So sensitive," Mydei growled at the discovery, nosing his way to the other's cheek. There was no distance between them. Mydei was practically on Phainon with his hands now cradling the other's head, his mouth wandering over his face to his jaw, then back to the neck, hearing more and more pathetic noises from the other, Mydei mouthed the area between Phainon's jaw and Adam's apple—a dangerous area. No one should be this exposed, but whatever possessed him now was bold enough to lick that area, let alone on an alpha. To his luck he was allowed. Humming happily, he found his way to the unmarked side.

Phainon eagerly tilted his head, allowing the other Alpha to explore. Mydei, now more than pleased, let his hands roam across the other's torso as he licked and sucked at his neck, humming in satisfaction at a soft whine.

Phainon's fingers tightened in Mydei's hair, quiet cries spilling past his lips with every brush of touch over skin no one else had dared to claim.

The urge to sink in his teeth right there, this instant, clouded Mydei's mind. And those noises of eagerness coming out from the other weren't helping his hazy mind at all.

He wanted him.

Mydei wanted Phainon.

He wanted him to be his. His only.

He felt himself opening his mouth, baring his teeth—just about to sink them in. *mine.* To claim what was his. *mine, mine, mine* To mark. To make—

Mydei stopped. Blinking to clear the blur in his eyes. His vision sharpened, suddenly very awake. He took a few breathes before taking in the sight beneath him.

Phainon was under him.

Phainon was *under* him…on *his* bed.

Phainon lay there, head turned to the side, panting heavily. Neck fully bared, slick with Mydei's saliva, gleaming in the dim light. His dazed, heat hazed gold—with barely any blue left, gazed up at him through heavy lids. His mouth was parted, his face flushed, and Mydei could even see the tears that had pooled along his lashes. He ignored how the Alpha inside him practically roared at the sight.

Mydei's eyes dropped to his own hands, frozen mid action, one over Phainon's chest, the other on his hips.

His eyes widened. And panic began to bloom.

What.

What was he—

His mind momentarily blacked out from the sudden panic. Until an impatient Phainon whined, fingers still tangled in his hair, and yanked him back down.

Mydei fell with an "oof" onto the other's chest. Mind buffering. Just as the panic threatened to fully consume him again, a face nuzzled into his head. Phainon inhaled softly, and suddenly the whole room filled with the scent of fresh citrus and golden dusk. Unnaturally calming,

Mydei felt his body go soft, too soft all the tension easing. And only then did he realize just how exhausted he really was.

And just as his panic—or whatever had happened could fully process, sleep claimed him once more, and he dropped deadweight on top of the other alpha. Exhausted.

…

Mydei woke up to something warm.

Warm—and comfortable in a way that made him want to stay asleep just a bit longer. It radiated heat, grounding him. He would've ignored it… if not for the rhythmic thump-thump beneath his ear.

He frowned. What the hell was that?

Blinking open his eyes, he found himself facing the half-open window. The morning breeze gently licked his face. Light filtered in soft gold. And yet, oddly, his view was… moving? Up and down?

Still, none of this explained the warmth beneath him.

Then the warmth shifted. Slightly. Like it was breathing.

Brows furrowing, Mydei flexed his back muscles and pushed himself up, only to realize—he was lying on his chest.

Something he never did.

And just as he was beginning to rise, he looked up and came face to face with a very… smiling, goofy, too-happy for this hour face.

Mydei scowled, eyelids heavy with sleep.

The face looked stupid.

And familiar.

His brain, still fogged from sleep, took a few moments longer than it should've. But eventually it clicked: he was practically on top of someone. And that someone was Phainon. Or rather, his chest which was warm, toned, annoyingly comfortable.

He'd spent the night laying on Phainon's chest.

Without a word, Mydei removed himself from the cozy body heat and rolled off the bed like a disgruntled cat. Standing, he made a straight line to the bathroom—ignoring the soft, whiny noise of protest from the lump still in his bed.

At the sink, he filled a small bowl and splashed cold water on his face—then over his head. The icy shock trailed down his reddish-blond strands to his bare torso, grounding him. Slowly, he opened his eyes to the mirror.

Yet unfortunately, his mind had recorded last night a little too clearly. The image of Phainon beneath him, panting heavily, neck fully bared—

He almost bashed his head into the mirror, feeling the heat rush straight to his abdomen.

He needed a shower.

A cold shower.

A long cold shower.

Chapter End Notes

My dearest Mydeimos…Yk you could've just shook the guy a bit harder to wake and not choose to lick him like a lioness grooming their cub right 👊

Anyway—

I got busy that I didn't had time to finish this off, but since I don't like it keep it not updated here's a quick something before I disappear again but be assured I'll update soon hehe—

My hand slipped again on the scenting part and I got carried away with it—again… Mind you it escalated further in the drafts but I had to keep the fic PG so—this is me being tamed okey —be glad—or be aware—

Lmao

Anyway Thank you for reading!

Chapter 3: Bread Crumbs

Chapter Summary

How to take care of a Phainon - Very painful and maybe a bit helpful guide by Mydei

Chapter Notes

Hi I'm back again with a another short one hehe

My mind is bubbling up with so many scenarios I could torture these two with that I can't seem to chose lol but since I'm nice—I chose this…

So here r some

CW ⚠️ - Possessive Behavior and uhh slight Dominant Behavior (+ more unhinged-cringe stuff)

Other then that's it's all crack, fluff and cute maybe a bit too on angst side too but it's so light don't worry abt it

Anyways

Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Mydei felt bothered.

Both of them were currently seated in his kitchen having breakfast, with Mydei offering small pieces of bread toward a certain Phainon, who still didn't seem to have woken up from the headspace Mydei had accidentally thrown him into.

But that was not what bothered him.

Mydei found himself ripping the next piece of bread a bit too harshly, hating how frustrated he felt. And next to him, Phainon waited to be fed, obediently wagging his imaginary tail excitedly.

And that wasn't why he was bothered either.

Just a few quints ago—

Mydei had finished his endlessly long shower. He dressed for the day and stepped out of the bathroom—only to be met face to face with a grinning Phainon, who looked like he'd been

standing there far too long.

Mydei opened his mouth in disbelief, then shook his head. Trying to ignore the other by walking pass him.

And that's when it hit him—the scent of smoked sandalwood with a hint of red peppercorn.

His scent.

Mydei's eyes widened at the realization.

Phainon was *reeking* of it.

Which clearly explained why the other looked so smug and satisfied. But Mydei was having none of it. His face burned. It was embarrassing—the memories of last night flashing across his vision, overlapping the face in front of him.

Phainon's unfocused eyes gazing up at him, panting, flushed—

Mydei pinched the bridge of his nose, shutting his eyes to shake off the image.

So even after *his* own shower, Mydei had taken his time—because he was patient, because he was calm. He'd refilled the bath. All for Phainon. This stupid Alpha, who clearly didn't function properly in his Subspace, could have a proper soak. And Mydei, who'd accidentally coated the other in too much of his scent could help wash it off.

He also had to carry the overgrown Alpha to the bathroom, simply because the other turned *unreasonably uncooperative* the second he saw what Mydei intended to do.

Mydei just didn't understand the fuss. He had stripped Phainon and tried to put him in the water—forcefully, yes—and Phainon scrambled out of the tub like a wet cat allergic to water. And since Mydei had already gotten ready for the day, he had to avoid getting splashed.

Except that was *impossible* when the other kept thrashing, trying to leap out and escape.

Mydei held him down by the shoulders from behind, guiding him into the shallow pool. But the white haired Alpha still tried to stand up—causing droplets to land on Mydei's freshly dry clothes.

"Deliverer, stop," Mydei muttered. Irritated. The other didn't listen.

So, as you can imagine, this had gotten messy. And to make it even more chaotic, Phainon's hands reached back to grab at Mydei's clothes—probably to gain leverage and thrash more easily.

"Stop that," Mydei winced. Phainon only let out a dissatisfied whine.

Mydei felt his frustration rising. Phainon wasn't listening. He kept kicking his feet, splashing water everywhere. Every time he resisted, Mydei's irritation grew—not just because of the mess, but also because the Alpha wasn't *obeying* him. Wasn't letting him take care of him.

And the growl building in his throat finally slipped out.

"Stop fucking struggling and behave." he snapped before he could stop himself.

The whining Alpha went completely pliant in his grip. Hands that had gripped his clothes retreated and dropped to their own sides, into the water. Legs that had kicked just stopped, folding themselves underneath.

And Mydei blinked at the sudden peace. Thrown off guard.

A few beats passed, and the bathroom went still and quiet, if not for the sound of running water from the tap next to them.

Phainon was quiet. And Mydei began to get worried again.

Because *what did he do this time?*

So as careful and caring as he could, he asked,

“Hey?” Mydei called out, still behind the other, his hands that were on Phainon’s shoulders now resting on his lap from where he was crouched down. “You okay?” he asked softly, trying not to scare the other more.

Then he laid a gentle hand on the Alpha’s shoulder, feeling him go tense, then relax under his touch.

He then saw Phainon nod. He sighed, relieved—yet he still couldn’t see the other’s face. And so quietly Mydei started to wash him, there was a part of him that screamed something was wrong.

Ignoring everything else, Mydei started washing him from the back, pouring water over him, then moving toward the front, caressing the skin as gently as he could, hoping it would be comforting, and gentle enough.

Just like that, he reached the neck.

He knew that was where most of the scent he had left behind remained. So his hand slowly reached there and touched, warning the other that he was going to start washing there.

But just as Mydei’s hand accidentally touches a bit too high over Phainon’s neck—right under the jaw, something wet touches his knuckles. He frowns. He hadn’t washed the other’s face yet, and there’s no way water could’ve reached his face, seeing Phainon’s hair was still dry.

Confusion bubbling with a hint of concern, Mydei’s hands roamed from his jaw toward the other’s cheek. He still can’t seem to see Phainon’s face fully. But he could feel the other flinch.

Indeed, the other Alpha’s face was wet and hot, which shouldn’t be possible, because the bath itself was cold. Mydei inhales a bit. The bath indeed smelled faintly of something charred and dimming in distress—but it isn’t very prominent that he didn’t even notice before.

“Phainon,” he finds himself calling out, the feeling of something like dread crawling upon him in some form of realization.

And his suspicion is confirmed correctly when he hears a soft sniffle. Barely audible, but there.

“Turn around,” Mydei asks, as gently as he can. He doesn’t want to make this more difficult than it already is.“Please.”

To his relief, the other does. Slowly turns his body enough to come face to face with him.

And Mydei feels his stomach lurch.

The other Alpha was crying.

Or rather Phainon *had been* crying—*silently*—all while Mydei didn't notice or was too busy trying to bath him. To add to that, this was his first time seeing the other cry this openly. His face was flushed and wet, his eyes wide and shimmering. Tears streaked down in silence—not a single sob—just an unrelenting stream that didn't stop, even after he turned. They slide down his cheeks and drip from his chin. Not much expression on him. He just stares back, looking apologetic.

When Mydei doesn't say anything, he sniffs again, face twisting into more of a grimace.

"I'm sorry," Phainon whispers, barely audible.

And Mydei hadn't heard Phainon speak since yesterday. And when he said "heard," he meant actual words, not the whines, not the sighs, not the soft noises he made when touched. So this—this was the first word in hours.

And it didn't make him feel any better.

If anything, it landed like a slap.

He looked at Phainon properly now, taking in his face, the soft blankness of it, the dull shine in his eyes, and the weight of concern hit him all at once. Along with guilt.

He doesn't like that look.

He wants it gone.

Mydei's mind was **loud**.

The urge to comfort him—to wipe that guilty, hollow look off his face, claws at Mydei's chest. It aches, sharper than it should. His hand is already reaching forward.

Had he hurt him?

He didn't mean to.

Never.

He would never hurt him.

Never meant to hurt him.

Never wants to see that expression on him.

Never again.

Mydei's calloused hands find the other's face, cradling it between his fingers as gently as he can.

Ignoring the hotness of those wet cheeks, his fingers begin to wipe tear after tear from beneath those hazy gold eyes as one by one slip by. Trying to keep them from reaching the rest of his face.

“I’m sorry,” Mydei finds himself saying sincerely. “I’m not mad” The gentleness of his own voice is so foreign to him, but he doesn’t care.

Phainon stares up at him for a bit, before closing his eyes. Nuzzling into the cold hands.

Mydei sighs in relief as he sees the other breathe in, calmness returning, the distressed smell in the room dulling as it happens. But still, the tears wouldn’t stop. Phainon’s lips trembled in his grasp—like he wanted to say something, but couldn’t.

“Tell me what you want,” Mydei says, his voice low—so low that he can feel the other shiver just a little at the sound of it.

He wants to hear it.

He wants to hear it from Phainon.

Even if it’s obvious—Mydei has to hear the other voice it.

He sees the other open his eyes between his palms, cheeks squished, eyes glassy, face wet. His lips parts softly as he whispers,

“You.”

And that was all it took.

Letting go of the face he was holding, Mydei slides into the bath without a care. His clothes cling uncontrollably to him as water soaks through the fabric. Yet he doesn’t care. He just sits down next to Phainon in the pool before opening his arms.

Without any hesitation, the white-headed Alpha crashes into him. Face burying deep into his Alpha’s shoulder, breathing in his scent, calming himself… practically settling himself on top of Mydei’s lap. Mydei can feel the wetness on his bare shoulder but finds himself not minding at all as a small chuckle escapes him. Phainon lets out a high-pitched whine, embarrassed.

Mydei feels the other Alpha’s body shook for a while before it disappears, then practically melts against the hold. Hands wrapped around his neck, still hiding in his shoulder.

“So clingy,” Mydei huffs, burying his nose into the snowy hair, nudging the other a bit.

He only gets a whine in return. Of course.

Mydei shakes his head, kissing the redness of the others ears before returning to clean, even if it means getting himself more soaked in the process. He still proceeds to wash, while the other still rests on his lap.

They get cleaned up. Mydei dresses them both, changing again himself without complaint. He lets Phainon borrow his clothes—slightly loose but brand new and unmistakably his. The red looks off on Phainon’s pale skin, doesn’t quite match the others usual pallet, but Mydei doesn’t care. If anything, something possessive swells in his chest at the sight. ***His*** alpha, wrapped in his clothes.

And yet

Here they were now.

In his kitchen.

With a *very bothered* Mydei.

And a clueless Phainon who was staring up at his bread piece being tortured, mouth half open in anticipation.

Mydei twisted the bread in his fingers, watching the crushed bread slowly puff back up to its usual state before throwing it into his own mouth, ignoring the noise the other made in protest.

Whatever, he thinks as he breaks off another piece before shoving it at Phainon's mouth to shut him up.

As you can see, he was *bothered*.

And what bothered him more was the reason why he was bothered.

So he had gotten them both out of baths, fully cleaned, and gotten them dry and dressed in comfortable clothes. His clothes, completely normal. Nothing to be *bothered* about at all.

But the moment Phainon stopped smelling like smoked sandalwood…it affected him more than he'd like to admit.

Yes, the clothes were his. Technically. But they were brand new, untouched by wear, unworn by him. They didn't carry his scent.

And that… that made him feel strangely restless. Uneasy in a way he couldn't quite name. And that feeling kept nagging in side of his brain.

And so here he was, expressing his frustration on the poor bread.

Now that he thinks about it, it's almost funny. Before, it was Phainon who was affected by this. But why is he so affected when he was the one who wanted this… Had his stupid crus-favoritism gone that far.

Throughout all of this, one thing Mydei had realized was he cared for Phainon. More than he had thought before. That he strangely liked the devoted attention he was getting, by this Phainon.

It just confuses him. He adores Phainon as his equal, his rival, his partner, a soldier on the battlefield. He finds time for their spars and looks forward to them, just so he can have that moment of heat—of them losing to their roughness and strength when they're head to head. When they bicker over the smallest disagreements, one's rude and pushes snarky comments, the other just matches him perfectly. He admits he likes that. He likes they oppose each other. He likes that they fight.

But why was he liking *this* too?

These tender, almost fragile moments, with Phainon who's completely surrendered himself to him.

Mydei's alpha clawed at him ***'We conquered him.'*** No, they didn't. ***'He's ours.'*** No, he isn't.

This—

This felt strange.

And *wrong.*

But he does want it.

He wants this too.

A part of him does.

It's so perfectly molded into Phainon that Mydei can't believe what his emotions are saying. It's all confusing. He knows what he wants—and doesn't know at the same time.

Mydei looks at his Phainon.

Who's waiting there for another bite of bread. Big eyes blinking up at him and the bread, while a smile spread across his face. Looking exactly like the normal Phainon when it comes to food. The eyes just throw him off…that's the problem. Other than that, nothing here says it isn't normal. It had always been *Phainon.*

It's just…

Mydei finds himself asking before he could stop himself, breaking off another piece of bread, "Are you… okay with any of this?"

Even though it's fruitless and just an attempt to make himself feel better about this whole thing somehow. He still asked. Deep down, maybe he just didn't want to be rejected.

Phainon tilts his head at the question. Not understanding where it's coming from. Oblivious.

Mydei can feel his face fall a bit as he offers the bread, hand hanging midair, waiting for the other to take it.

To his surprise, Phainon stands up from where he sat abruptly, then makes himself comfortable in Mydei's lap—uninvited. Mydei doesn't protest. Just lets him. But startled nevertheless.

The other Alpha's hand, wordlessly reaches to take the bread piece he'd been offered, then takes it over to Mydei's closed mouth.

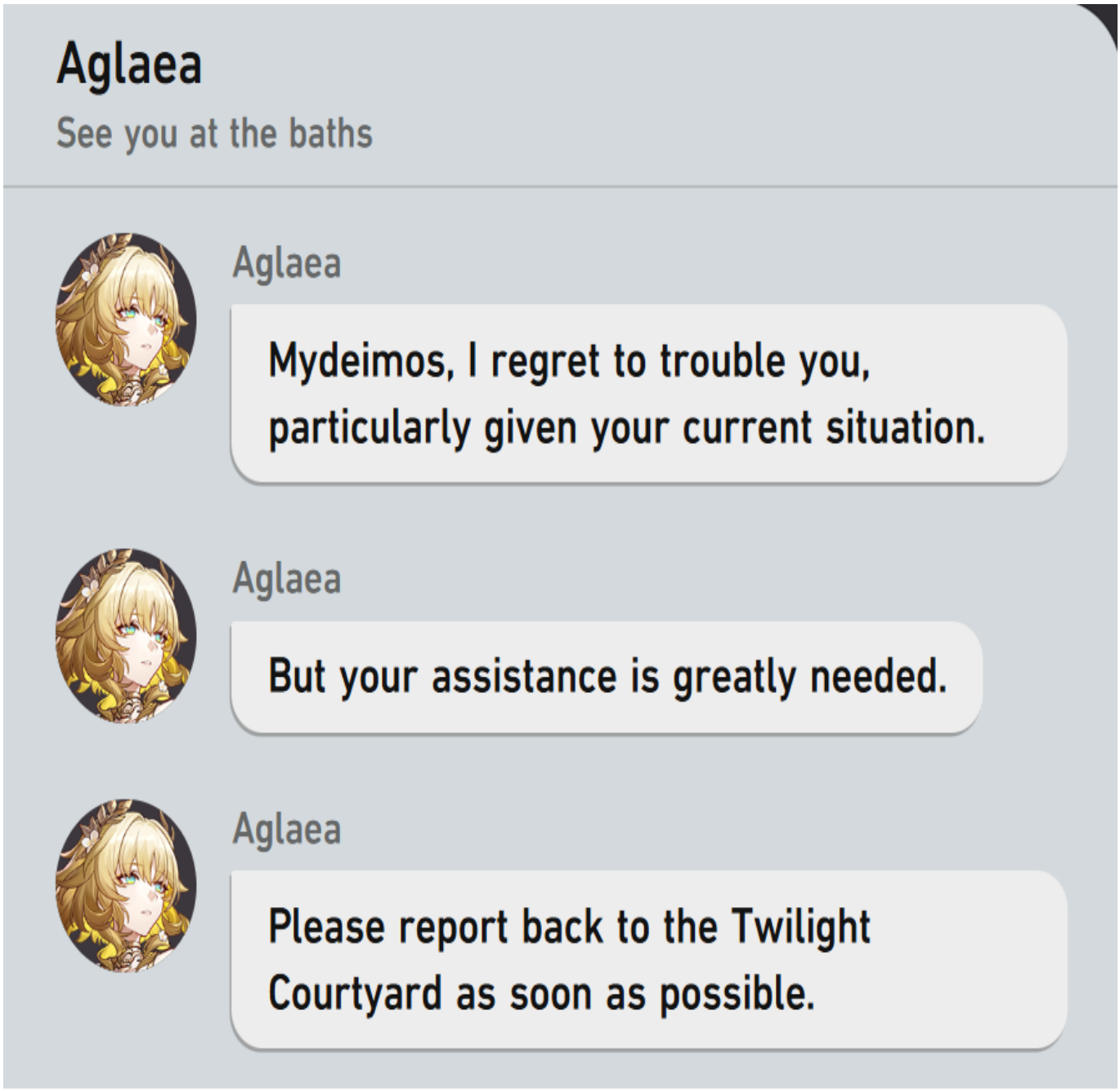
Waiting for it to open.

And so Mydei does not put much thought to it, and Phainon happily feeds the piece to him then wraps his arms around him—cuddling with absolutely no regard for personal space. He clings, practically climbing onto him, legs wrapped around Mydei's waist, face buried in his broad shoulder.

Mydei exhales, arms circling around the other's frame, one hand reaching up to gently pet his hair.

The question felt answered, in a way.

Somewhere in Mydei's quatres, his teleslate buzzed with a urgent message.



Chapter End Notes

My dearest Phainon…You coward—Don't you think you're safe by hiding in ur subspace 🫵 you will suffer the same fate somehow mister when I'm done with this MARK MY WORDS —

After reading your comments from chapter 2, I realized how horny some of y'all are…but don't worry I am too… SO I am considering making this a series with a second part after all this is over, one with yk *Mature Tag* hehe and I'll make Phai suffer more there—so they both r equally mortified of their instincts

Pfft are y'all enjoying the cringe THAT is the art of ABO fics—

Anyway Ig Mydei is winning with the feeling realization part, He's not quite there but very close

I do apologize if this is like rushed + my grammer!!! I'm like torn between work and wanting to finish this

So ye

Hope you guys enjoy this chaos of a fic!

Thank you for reading

Chapter 4: A Date

Chapter Summary

• Mydei is summoned by Aglaea, there a serious problem at hand.

• The duo goes on a date, kiss, and Mydei finds Phainon cute…(not clickbait)

—Maybe some shit in between.

Chapter Notes

Hello!!!

I'm back! Phew I just had the most annoying two weeks with 2 whole ass assignments + a stupid project at work that did not give me time even upload even a slightest bit of a chapter.

But alas it's all ended I'm currently on a break for few days so I could finally get back to writing yippie!

All that aside I might've had to change the tags a tiny bit, bc in attempt to add some violence it got violent lmao

Also added a minor villain who isn't important at all pls ignore him he's there too, bro just here to spies up some drama. Some characters might look too ooc.

There was also a problem regarding the images I attached is the previous chapters I'm sorry but I think I fixed them. Pls do tell me if y'all not see the images. There's non in this chapter btw dw!

As for the CW ⚠️
•Posseive/Protective Behavior
•Feral Behavior
•Usual Unhinged and Cringe stuff
•Blood and Violence (slightly detailed)
•Mentions of Drugs and use
•uhh and Mpreg—mentioned?

Anyways idk how this got this serious might've been my demons writting—like wtf happened

Not too dramatic I hope

Im so sorry I swear this was supposed to crack

Also if y'all are wandering what timeline this is—just imagine a normal Amphoreus with no Irontomb, no Lygussy— just black tide that simply there but not tooo violent (just bc we need our Demigods in here) + Kremnos being rebuilded with all the factions and ofc with abo!

Ahem

Pls enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Mydei was never the type to show public affection. He wasn't the kind to hug, shake hands, or—Titan forbid—touch anyone in front of watchful eyes. It wasn't disgust, nor ignorance of courtship. No. He simply never saw the point in wasting time with meaningless skinship. To him, touch was a weapon, a language reserved for battles and war. Nothing more.

Outside of that, he was an Alpha who kept his hands to himself. They either folded across his chest or hung at his sides, rigid and steady. He liked his space. He guarded it. Everyone around him knew this well—especially the other Heirs. And they respected it.

Which is why he understood the stares. Why he could feel them drilling into him from every corner of the Twilight Courtyard.

For instance, Castorise—her jaw slack, openly gawking in what could only be described as awe, for some titan-damned reason leaning closer to Hyacine as though needing confirmation that this was really happening. Cifera lingered in the shadows like a restless wildcat, but even she had tilted her head, eyes sharp and curious on him. And Aglaea… Aglaea watched him with that unnervingly knowing look. A look that said she understood. That she saw too much.

The stares themselves weren't surprising. Mydei expected them. What he hadn't expected was the burning in his ears, the creeping heat rising to his face, or the way his grip—unthinking, unrelenting—tightened around the hand he was holding.

Yes. The undying crown prince, Mydeimos of Kremnos, son of Gorgo—now stood in the center of Twilight Courtyard, face burning like a chastised groveboy, while his hand remained firmly intertwined with their Deliverer.

Phainon, of course, looked like he didn't have a single care in the world. Broad grin on his face, shoulders loose, standing there as if the scene wasn't making the entire room silently combust with implications. Still in his own little subspace, still oblivious—or worse, pretending to be oblivious—to the many, many conclusions everyone in this room was no doubt drawing.

It had all started the moment Aglaea summoned him on such short notice. Duty had called, and he had wasted no time in answering. Well—almost no time.

He had made one detour.

Straight to Phainon's quarters.

Which, in hindsight, had been a mistake. Or at least not the smartest idea. Because what should have been a swift "fetch and go" became… something else. Dressing Phainon…of all was an impossible task and had eaten up precious time. Mydei had insisted on it, though. The white-haired alpha had been half-wrapped in attire with aesthetically unmatching red and golds(Mydei's own), looking nowhere near considerable to be presented before the heirs. So Mydei ever so kindly had stripped him out of it, tugging him into something decent. His own clothes, to be precise. Usual dark shirt that fit, trousers and boots.

The outer coat he abandoned halfway through. Too many buckles. Too many straps. He didn't have the patience and time.

And the *choker*. He hadn't forgotten that. He had fished through Phainon's wardrobe and grabbed the first leather one he could find, fastening it around his neck—high enough to hide the mark he'd left there. He had ignored the frankly concerning number of chokers in that closet. Didn't even want to question it.

Not that any of it mattered in the end, because seconds later he'd had Phainon shoved against the wall, face buried in his neck and collar, scenting him until the other alpha's knees nearly buckled—

The point was, he had still made it here. He had still barged into the Courtyard as normally as he could, dragging along their Deliverer who looked presentable enough, and—most importantly—in one piece.

Now, though, with every eye fixed on them, Mydei could feel the tips of his hair matching the flush across his face. Crimson, hot, impossible to disguise.

The stares didn't falter for some time.

Until Aglaea cleared her throat—sharp enough to slice through the silence.

"I truly apologize for calling you at such short notice," she began, her tone formal, steady. "But unfortunately, a new threat plagues our city, and I need all of your attention on this case."

Her gaze shifted. It landed firmly, almost accusingly, on the Kremnoen Prince. "Especially you, Mydeimos."

Mydei hadn't been addressed so directly, so pointedly—by Aglaea in a long while. Not even after the incident yesterday. She was choosing to ignore it, then. Though there was a flicker of something…an apology, perhaps when her eyes brushed past him and Phainon.

Then it clicked.

Nothing would make her call him out this openly, under these circumstances… unless—

"It is a matter involving a Kremnoen," Aglaea confirmed aloud, almost reading the thought off his face. "An Alpha."

The words landed heavy. She turned, gesturing for Mydei to follow.

He did. His boots trailed after the Goldweaver's light steps as she led him to a closed-off wing, unlocking the door with a quiet click.

The moment the door opened, the smell hit him.

A scent of an Omega in heat.

Sharp, cloying, and impossible to mistake. Mydei stopped at the threshold, shoulders going rigid. Aglaea entered without hesitation, but she spared him a brief glance over her shoulder—understanding, but not demanding.

He wouldn't be affected, no. His control was iron. But stepping inside meant intrusion, offense, violation of an Omega's vulnerability. That was something he would not do. He stayed by the door.

Phainon, though, had already stiffened beside him at the scent. Not badly—but enough. Mydei shifted subtly, keeping his body angled in front, shielding him from the sight within the room. His hand found Phainon's, thumb brushing circles into pale knuckles, grounding him.

The other Alpha heir looked tense, confused, but still held himself together. Better than Mydei expected, considering the haze of subspace that still lingered over him. If anyone else had noticed, there might have been whispers. But Aglaea only carried on, unbothered.

What a dangerous woman, Mydei thought. To know their limits so well. To calculate outcomes before they even moved. She acted as though she knew them more intimately than they knew themselves. Dangerous—and frightening.

Still, he kept his distance. From the doorway, he observed.

The woman lying on the infirmary bed looked Okheman from her features, her crumpled attire confirming it. She was unconscious, her brow twisted faintly in pain. The scent-blockers Hyacine might've applied clung thick to her skin, masking the worst of it—but not enough. It was obvious. She was in heat.

Mydei frowned. His mind was already weighing questions—why here? why her? why involve them at all?

Before he could ask, movement stirred inside the room.

Anaxa emerged.

He looked as though he'd been waiting for the first excuse to leave, expression bored as ever. A cloth covered the lower half of his face, no doubt to dull the scent. The omega professor's voice sharp with irritation.

"What is wrong with you, woman?" he snapped, not even waiting for introductions. "You bring two Alpha heirs to a room like this?"

His eyes flicked toward the threshold—and froze.

Mydei and Phainon stood side by side, close enough that their joined hands were obvious. Mydei's thumb still idly circling. His posture protective, deliberate. And Phainon pale and tense behind him.

Anaxa blinked once. His face twisted. A mix of fascination—and disgust before he scoffed under his breath. Shaking his head. He said nothing else, he turned his back, his coat sweeping behind him as he strode away.

Aglaea, who had only watched with the faintest of smiles, ignored the tension in the room. As if none of it had happened. She stepped forward, her tone even, almost too casual.

“This omega woman is a victim of the Kremnoen we spoke of earlier,” she began, moving closer to the bed. Her hand rested lightly on the damp forehead of the distressed figure. At her touch, the woman’s shaking eased, if only a little.

Aglaea’s voice lowered. “The worst of it is this: she wasn’t born an omega. She was a beta. Just days ago, her family reported her missing. Cifera found her soon after, but by then…” She paused, her fingers brushing damp hair back from the woman’s temple. “By then she had already shifted. Forced into a secondary gender she was never meant to have.”

The silence that followed was heavy, pressing against the walls.

“It was no natural turn,” Aglaea continued, her eyes moving over the gathered heirs before settling on Mydei. “The Alpha who fled the scene left behind more than one broken body. This one survived. Others were not so fortunate. Some were even Alphas themselves.”

Mydei leaned forward with an arched brow. “An Alpha, drugged? That’s… not easy to manage.”

“Indeed,” Aglaea said. “Which means what we’re dealing with is not ordinary.” She straightened, her tone sharpening as though to cut through the disbelief. “It is a drug. A highly modified rut–heat compound. Potent enough to trigger a cycle even in those who were never meant to experience one. Potent enough to drag a beta into another gender altogether.”

Mydei’s throat worked as he swallowed, his voice quieter, sardonic in the way it always was when he wanted to mask unease. “So not just cruel, but...”

“Efficient,” Aglaea corrected grimly. “It’s been circulating for some time. Sold, traded, distributed in shadows. The suspect behind it has been confirmed as a Kremnoen—a fleeting one. Which makes them slippery. Cifera tracked the trail, but it broke.”

The cat-girl, leaning against the walls just near the door frame, flicked her tail with irritation. “He knows how to vanish. No footprints. No scent. Nothing. It’s like chasing smoke.”

Aglaea’s hand lingered on the victim’s forehead a moment longer before she finally withdrew, her eyes darkening. “But he cannot run forever. Not from us.”

Mydei had asked if there were any clues, his hand still firmly holding Phainon’s as though the two of them were a single piece.

Aglaea shook her head. “Nothing concrete. A scar under an eye and that he’s Kremnoen. Middle-aged. Alpha. The accent gives it away though” Her tone was even, but the weight of the words left the room heavier than before.

Eventually, they were excused to leave. Mydei politely left, taking Phainon with him before Aglaea could elaborate further on their possible inconvenience to others.

The moment they stepped outside, something like shame clutched at his chest. His own blood, his own people—Kremnoen, of all names—tied to this. They were known to stay clear of such filth, a

standard he had upheld fiercely, ensuring none in their ranks gave reason for suspicion. Yet one had slipped beneath his notice, hiding for who knew how long. And now there were victims. More victims. Each thought weighed heavier, pressing him further into silence as they walked.

He was so caught in the spiral of it that he didn't notice Phainon had slowed, then stopped altogether—until the grip on his hand tightened back, tugging him to a halt. He made a faint, confused sound, turning his head to question him—only to find Phainon's attention fixed elsewhere.

Not on him.

But on a restaurant across the corner, its lantern-light spilling warm and golden onto the street. Phainon stood there staring at it like a child spotting sweets in a market, eyes locked on the store with a kind of single-minded hunger. Then, inevitably, his stomach growled loud enough to be heard.

Mydei blinked. And when Phainon blinked back at him, almost sheepish, waiting as like asking for permission…he could only stare back with raised brow. Of course. Even at this hour, this man was hungry. Of course.

He exhaled sharply through his nose, shaking his head in endear—disbelief. And then he nodded.

Phainon beamed instantly, beyond happy, before tugging him toward the restaurant without hesitation.

Mydei let himself be dragged. Somewhere in the back of his mind, he had already given up on any restraint where Phainon was concerned. Better this than then encountering a situation like today morning.

So the thoughts of Kremnoen, of failure and shame, bled away, leaving him only with the ridiculousness of the present. His focus shifted entirely, helplessly, to the Alpha pulling him along like a spoiled heir eager for his favorite treat. And Mydei, for all his composure, followed—ignoring the curious stares, the hushed whispers of passing citizens that trailed after.

He ignored them because he chose to. Because he had already decided, whatever others saw, however absurd it might look—he would allow himself this. Allow himself to be dragged along, tethered to Phainon's whims, no matter how foolish it seemed.

And in the privacy of his own silence, he bit his cheek to keep from smiling.

Because the truth was simple, and damning: he was terribly weak when it came to this particular person.

"Ah, Lord Phainon, Lord Mydei," a middle-aged beta woman, Eleni greeted warmly when they stepped inside. "Welcome."

Mydei gave her a polite nod. He'd been here before, dragged along more times than he could count. One of Phainon's favorite haunts. Usually, the white-haired Alpha would sweep in with that blinding grin, charming greetings spilling out like a showman on stage.

Not today.

Today, Phainon only blinked at the woman… then promptly turned his blank stare onto Mydei, like a man who'd forgotten how to speak.

The woman's brows pinched with concern.

Mydei, quick on his feet, cleared his throat and covered in smoothly,"Don't mind him. The Deliverer's off duty today—lost a bet, sulking. Tired, that's all." A lie delivered with perfect courtesy.

At his side, Phainon nearly let out a pathetic little sound—Mydei's boot stomped discreetly on his foot before it could escape. The Alpha's eyes almost watered, and Mydei pretended nothing happened.

"Ah, poor soul," the woman murmured with sympathy. "Shall I prepare your usual private room?"

"Yes. Thank you," Mydei answered smoothly.

While they waited, a young couple entered, a tall Alpha and his heavily pregnant Omega. Both offered polite greetings towards them before moving to a table nearby.

Mydei told himself not to look too long. And failed.

The Alpha pulled out a chair, helping his mate ease down with tender care. The Omega's grateful smile lingered as he settled. Simple. Ordinary. A sight Mydei had never spared a thought for before.

But the image lodged itself in his mind anyway—Phainon, pregnant and heavy with his pups, Mydei fussing over him with ridiculous, endless love—

What.

In a attempt to not smash his head hard to the nearest wall or table, Mydei's grip on Phainon's hand tightened hard enough to make the other wince. A half-strangled yelp escaped Phainon before he twisted toward him in confusion. His hazy gaze tracked the line of his Alpha's eyes… and landed on the mated Omega across the room.

An Omega.

His Alpha was staring at…*an Omega.* That was all Phainon's dazed, possessive brain processed.

Normally, Rational, conscious, non-hazed Phainon would look at this scene, swallow his annoying feelings, and make a joke at Mydei for staring at omegas like a helpless, brute romantic—or jab him while batting his eyes or winking like a bro.

Nope.

Whatever self-control Phainon had, his Alpha did not. Because who the fuck steals ***his*** Alpha's attention away from him? When he shook Mydei's hand, the other looked like he was fighting his inner demons or something, which again, processed wrong in the hazed white-haired mind.

So slightly irritated, Phainon just leaned in and bit his Alpha's bare shoulder. It wasn't harsh, but it was enough to sting.

The effect was immediate. Mydei's head snapped around so fast it nearly cracked.

And there was Phainon, smiling sweetly now that he had his Alpha's full attention, draping an arm around his waist like he belonged there.

Publicly.

In full view.

A mating gesture.

The timing couldn't be worse—the owner was just returning, calling that their room was ready—when Mydei acted fast. His hand shot up, clamping Phainon around the shoulders and neck in what could pass as a competitive Alpha headlock.

To everyone else, playful roughhousing. To him, a desperate damage-control maneuver. The Alpha in his arms grunted, struggling against the hold. Mydei didn't care. Not right now.

"Excuse us," Mydei told the woman calmly, dragging Phainon toward their private room without another word.

The woman only gave them a confused little look, but said nothing. To her, this was simply their usual… dynamic.

Mydei was so tired. The exhaustion he felt weighed on him both mentally and physically. There was a rogue Alpha among his people, a dangerous drug that might threaten countless lives—both his and many others'. The fragile peace they had just been enjoying could be shattered at any moment. And then there was Phainon, the Deliverer, acting as if they were a mated pair, oblivious to it all, as if nothing else in the world mattered at all right now. The Deliverer he had known for years, revealing some parts of himself that he had never even imagined before. And then there were his own confused, mixed feelings. He had, in some measure, accepted Phainon's overly aggressive devotion, which had seemingly appeared from nowhere. That he's so surprised how well he handled it all. Well mostly.

He was just so exhausted. Usually, he wouldn't mind pressure and stress, beating up Phainon in sparring— blowing off steam was an option…but right now it wasn't and all that felt too much—especially these complicated emotions.

Maybe that was why Mydei had the Deliverer sprawled across his lap, back pressed against his bare chest. His nose was buried deep into the other's scent glad, inhaling the calming aroma. One hand

pressed possessively over the toned lower stomach, the dark shirt slightly lifted to expose skin to his touch. The other hand held Phainon's mid-air, as if restraining him—not that there'd needed any restraining.

The food they had ordered sat forgotten on the nearby table. Cold.

The booth smelled strongly of Mydei's smoked sandalwood, dominating the other scents, while his own nose was the only thing accessing Phainon's.

Phainon was indeed sweeter-smelling than most Alphas Mydei had encountered or been with. The latter had always been insecure about the hint of sweetness in his own scent, but Mydei thought otherwise. The golden musk was strong, but the subtle citrusy sweetness was what he craved. It made his stomach bloom with warmth, somehow calming and grounding him, almost making him want to taste it.

He could feel the other arching against him when his mouth brushed lightly over the sun tattoo. A low, growl slipped past him while the man in his lap made a needy noise.

Mydei didn't even know how it led to this. All he remembered was getting inside the booth, sitting down, getting their orders, and somewhat feeding Phainon along the way while he ate himself. Somewhere along the line, a small crumb had been left on the side of his mouth, too insignificant for him to notice amidst everything else. He wasn't even bothered by it, until Phainon leaned in.

Phainon had leaned so close, half on his lap, that Mydei forgot to breathe.

Their faces were inches apart, breaths mingling. His mind was slow, but Phainon closed the distance in an instant, pressing his lips to the side of Mydei's mouth without care, licking the crumb off sweetly before returning to his original position—still half on his lap. Mydei's brain nearly shut down, thirty-three million gears turning, trying to process what had just happened. It wasn't a kiss. No. But it was. And Mydei's tired brain and weak heart were too furious to let it slide, because the next thing he knew, he had manhandled the other with so much frustration.

Which was how they ended up like this.

Not that Mydei's tired brain had registered fully on what he was doing so publicly. The owner could barge in at any moment and witness all of it. His rational mind did acknowledged this from somewhere deep inside.

Yet no. He wanted to be greedy for a moment. He wanted to be selfish. He wanted to have this feeling entirely for himself. He wanted to forget everything and just stay like this forever, away from prying eyes, away from the weight of the world, just here, like this, with his Phainon.

Mydei's tongue licked his mark over the sun tattoo. Leather strap that wrapped there before had torn and thrown somewhere during the process. The mark on Phainon's neck was almost healed—curse the other's quick healing abilities. Better than an average human. Sooner or later, the man would wake up and everything would return to their usual routine. Phainon might not even remember properly, while Mydei would be left burdened with the memory, forced to act as if it had all been fine.

His teeth nearly grazed the soft porcelain skin at the thought, but he was careful, pinching with his lips rather than biting. The other bolted slightly, and Mydei purred, lifting his face from the neck toward the other's ear, mouthing at the ear lobe. He heard the whine he had expected.

The hand pressing over the stomach shifted slightly, feeling the other's breath shudder while the soft skin spasmed subtly. The touch was new. Mydei found himself rubbing in circles absentmindedly while nuzzling the back of Phainon's head, white hair brushing his face.

His mind wondered back to previous thoughts as he touched the flat abdomen—imagining Phainon carrying his pups. He was no fool; he knew an Alpha could never carry children. But that didn't mean he couldn't pretend, couldn't try—He pressed firmly on the stomach, his mind too hazy to even question reality, making Phainon whimper out pathetically. Like he could read Mydei's dark fantasies.

Smiling to himself, Mydei's nose wandered back towards the other Alpha's scent glad, until—

Smash.

A loud, alarming clash ripped through their session. Mydei had to tear himself away from the haze to even register what the sound meant. Blinking, he was on his feet the moment his eyes cleared, setting the now distressed man down before rushing outside—barely giving himself a heartbeat to think.

The sound had been unmistakable. A chair being thrown. That was confirmed the second he stepped into the open and spotted the broken remains just a few feet away. His gaze swept quickly, registering the scene.

The restaurant owner was pressed against the wall, pale and frozen. The whole restaurant had erupted into chaos, the handful of customers fleeing. Only three figures remained now—the couple from earlier, and a newcomer.

An Alpha, by the stance of him. The brute had one hand locked around the collar of the mated Alpha, lifting him clean off the ground with inhuman strength. The omega was on their knees, wrecked with panic, eyes wide with horror as their mate struggled against the iron grip.

Mydei moved to intervene—but stopped dead in his tracks when the conversation carried over to him. He didn't catch all of it. Only a word. One word that mattered.

"…the *DRUG*, you fool." The accent was unmistakable. He'd have known it anywhere. That precise lilt, that familiar difficulty with certain syllables—he'd spoken like that himself during his earliest years here. Even dressed carefully in Okehman attire, the man couldn't fool him.

Kremnoen. One of his. The situation was heated—too heated—but Mydei ducked into the shadows at the edge of the room, choosing to just observe. His jaw was tight, his hands loose at his sides.

"I—I don't have a-any left!" the struggling Alpha gasped. "Please, you have to understand—" He didn't finish. The Kremnoen Alpha snarled, shoving him hard to the ground. His gray-and-dark hair fell messily into his face as he dragged a frustrated hand over it, then spat a curse in Kremnoen before laying into the man with vicious kicks.

The omega's cry was gutting, tearing out of him as he collapsed beside his mate, body curling up, sobbing openly. He reached with trembling hands, desperate to shield his Alpha even as the blows rained down.

That was enough.

Fuck it.

Mydei emerged from the shadows.

The room stilled instantly. The brute's assault stopped dead, every sense in the space pulled taut as though the air itself had gone razor-thin. Mydei didn't need to say a word. He stepped forward with calculated calm, every inch of him seething presence, his body a wall between the exit and the others.

The Alpha froze and went pale.

Mydei's eyes narrowed, cold and unwelcoming. The growl rumbling in his chest carried more weight than a scream. What an insult this man was to his people.

The brute began backing away—slow, cautious—but Mydei was already turning his attention elsewhere. The injured Alpha on the ground was curled on the ground, coughing hard, clutching at his sides.

"Get him to the side," Mydei ordered the omega, his voice a low, calm fury. "And do not dare leave."

The omega nodded through trembling lips and half-dragged, half-held his mate away. The shop owner hurried to usher them to a safer corner, where both collapsed into a pile of shock and relief. Only then did Mydei refocus on the Kremnoen.

"Your name." He didn't ask. He demanded.

The Alpha trembled where he stood. The scent alone—the raw, thunderous presence of the Kremnoen crown prince was more than enough to crush lesser men. Still, the fool's eyes darted around, hunting for an opening, a way out.

No answer.

Mydei's frown deepened. His long stride carried him forward, hand snapping out to seize the man's face, iron-hard fingers forcing his chin up until their eyes locked. The weaker Alpha shook under the grip, whether from the hold itself or from pure terror.

"Did I not make myself clear?" Mydei spat, voice sharp, dangerous. The man sputtered, words catching in his throat—almost spilling his name, yet choking it back, still clinging to that useless resistance. His hands, trembling but bold enough, reached for Mydei's side, clawing desperately at the fabric.

That earned another growl. But not from Mydei.

From across the room.

Phainon.

Mydei hadn't even registered his presence—his shadow had trailed him in silently. The Alpha hadn't interfered, keeping distance as if not wanting to interrupt Mydei's pray. But the touch on Mydei's side, the struggling hands…that had been too much. The sound had slipped from him regardless.

Mydei ignored it. His focus stayed locked on the trembling Alpha in his grip. Scar under the eye. Heavy accent. The description fit. Perfectly. Exactly as the culprit Chiper had been hunting.

“Speak, *chorikós*,” Mydei hissed, patience bleeding thin.

The man shuddered.

But instead of obedience, his lips twisted into a weak smirk. His gaze flicked back and forth, feigning control where there was none.

“*My prince*,” he said at last in Kremnoen—sly, but trembling all the same. “Oh, was I interrupting your—“ Then the man asks his eyes flicking briefly toward the white-haired Alpha. Before mouthing *“date”*

Mydei felt his eye twitch, he really wanted to shove the man’s mouth on to the ground. Where it belonged. Though he held his own. To show provocation wouldn’t work. Not like this.

But the man in his hold saw the faltering. He smirked, growing bolder.

“Is that why your *dog* is growling at me?” he sneered, tightening his grip on the hand that still had a dead lock on his face.

Mydei shouldn’t let the provocation reach him—he really shouldn’t. Yet the moment Phainon was dragged into it, the restraint somewhat snapped.

The next thing he knew, the Alpha’s jaw broke under his hand.

Gasps echoed from somewhere in the room.

No one dared step in.

And the man, bloodied and terrified, still refused to surrender. He spat some blood onto the floor before fishing something from his clothes. Mydei lunged to stop him, but the man slashed his arm with his hands. Small scratch that resulted a small wound. The wound wasn’t much, he’d heal. But it was enough to make Phainon snarl, angry and feral.

And Mydei—just for a second, got distracted.

His head turned slightly to look at the other in concern.

Too distracted.

The next moment something liquid splattered across his eyes. His grip faltered as he reeled back, covering his face. The man tried to flee.

But he didn’t get far.

A terrifying, furious Deliverer, uncanny to his usual self—slammed him to the ground, pinning him hard, restraining him as if he’d tear him apart. The room held its breath while Mydei clawed at his own vision, trying to clear it.

The second his vision cleared, after blinking away the spots, Mydei saw the struggling man pinned under Phainon. A mix of relief and fury surged through him—glad that Phainon had the upper

hand, furious that the situation had spiraled this far.

He blinked harder, trying to clear his vision completely, then moved to step forward, intent on helping Phainon restrain the man. But the Kremnoen was proving more difficult than expected. Even though Phainon was stronger, his mind was hazed—too many openings, too much reckless focus. And the other Alpha saw the chance right there.

Then, before Mydei could even react, the bastard launched upward and though the broken jaw, stubbornly sank his teeth deep into Phainon's neck.

Mydei felt his heart stop.

He see's the way Phainon's eyes widened, shifting from shock to struggle… then faltering, going pliant over the Alpha's strength.

No.

No no no no.

Not again.

Mydei's heart hammered loud enough to drown out the world, pumping against his ribs, roaring in his ears. His own Alpha threatened to burst free right then.

He saw **red**. His jaw clenched so tight it hurt, teeth bared like he was seconds away from tearing the man apart. Rage was spilling into every muscle, into every bone.

He almost lost it.

He almost lashed out on the man outright.

But then—before he could've striked, the said man screamed. A sound of pure brutality.

Mydei jerked to the side to see what had happened, and what he saw made him stop cold.

Phainon.

His eyes were narrowed into molten gold, burning with a fury Mydei had never once seen in him before. His teeth bared in animalistic rage, claws sinking deep and ripping across the man's face without mercy. Blood sprayed. His leg pressed hard against the Alpha's ribs, crushing down with sickening cracks. The sound made the room wince, made Mydei's stomach turn—but he couldn't look away.

Because the Alpha before him wasn't just angry.

He was feral.

His larger figure loomed over the Kremnoen's desperate flailing, shoving him down with sheer brutality. The man's face was twisted, his body snapping forward and down. He had no chance.

And Mydei, through the shock and fury…could only watch in awe.

So this is what Goldweaver meant by *'Biting his head off'*

Literally.

Oh.

Oh.

Soon enough, the man went limp. Terror and pain broke him first, and then unconsciousness. His body sagged against the marble floor like discarded trash.

Above him, Phainon stood hunched over, chest heaving, blood dripping from his claws. His fingers twitched like he didn't know whether to grab or strike again. Blank, wild-eyed, trembling. The sight wasn't pleasant to anyone in the room, it was chilling. Mydei knew the three present somewhere in the room, who'd dared watch their Deliverer in such a state, were beyond terrified now.

And the Deliverer himself… Mydei was certain he'd regret what he'd just did apon waking, even if he had no control over it.

Taking a breath, Mydei forced himself to steady. He approached slowly and measured, cautious, as though nearing a wounded, cornered beast. Because that's what Phainon was right now, not in control, but wild and raw, a beast caught in their instincts.

"Phai," Mydei said quietly. He wasn't even sure what to call him to reach through the haze.

But the head turned.

Phainon looked hollowed out. His wide, golden eyes stared through him, and that ugly mark bleeding along his collarbone, beads of gold dripping with it.

That *bastard.*

He'll deal with that later.

Mydei extended a hand. Careful and caring. He saw the hesitation flicker across Phainon—his fingers twitching, his entire body caught in a fight-or-flight snap.

But the second he caught Mydei's scent, Phainon moved. He lunged.

Not to attack, but to cling.

Mydei braced himself for the worst, ready to be clawed or shoved, but instead, Phainon collapsed into him. Hands gripped tight, his entire body throwing itself forward for comfort, for anchor, burying his face into Mydei's shoulder as if he hadn't just mauled another Alpha into unconsciousness.

Gasps rippled around the room, but Mydei didn't care. He caught him, steadying his weight.

He hugged him back.

And despite everything, Phainon—the blood, the brutality—the terror…Mydei couldn't stop the small smile that crept onto his lips.

Because honestly?

He was kind of cute.

Chapter End Notes

Well Mydei, you sure found wrongest moment to think Phainon was cute…

Anyhow

Well Titans be damned because who let me cook…(0v0)

You wouldn't believe I added this random man just so I could connect him with the second part of the story—somehow OKEY don't worry I think this will be the last brutal chapter I'd ever associate this fic with— maybe

Also I'd like to officially apologize to Phainon, my man I'm sorry for letting you be chewed like this 🙏

And Mydei why am I making you suffer like this. I'm truly terribly sorry but it is for sheer entertainment so pls understand. 🙏

Pfft

Anyway rant done. There will be more fluff and crack next I promise,

I have no idea how this fic came this far but thank you for all your kudos and comments

Really *really* appreciate every single one of them.

Thank you for reading!

Chapter 5: Between his arms

Chapter Summary

Hyacine needs a break, Mydei needs a break and Phainon needs to wake.

Chapter Notes

Hello!

Here's another short one!

CW⚠️ (if ya need it)
•Possessive Behavior
•Slight feral Behavior
•Slightly described blood and gore
•Usual unhingness
•Some sexual tension? Idk probably…?

And might be ooc on some parts for comedic crack reasons!

Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Hyacine wouldn't call today one of the worst days she ever had. No. She has had far more worse days then this. Even so, she had to admit—it had been quite eventful.

The beta-turned-omega had been brought in such a rush that she didn't even properly hear the full story, too busy staring at the distressed omega who looked to be in far greater pain than a regular omega in heat—until Cipher smacked her with her tail, snapping her out of whatever thoughts had been lingering in her head.

"Snap outta it, kid. She needs painkillers," Cipher had muttered before disappearing again.

And after that, everything unfolded so fast it blurred into a haze. One moment she was treating the patient, taking blood samples, and the next—Anaxa barged in without a hint of grace, shooing her and her staff out of the room. Very unkind, yet so like her mentor that she found herself waiting outside, questions piling in her head, while he did… well, whatever it was the omega professor had in mind for that poor woman.

One moment she was here, the next she was there, conducting tests and before she could even properly process that, she was summoned into a room full of the other Heirs.

And eventually, her day finally began to crawl toward an end. Well—not truly an end. But she allowed herself a pause, a brief break, after the sheer exhaustion she'd endured from Anaxagoras' diagnosis and, of course, his experiments.

And so she found herself outside at last, in the courtyard, with little Ica gently pressing a cold water bottle against her face. Hyacine made a soft noise at the chill, but smiled at Ica—tired, yet warm—as she took the bottle. She took a small sip, then sank down onto a nearby bench, leaning back into it, head tilted toward the sky.

So many questions lingered. Curiosity pulled at her, but it was mixed with a heaviness, a sadness, at the possibility that a looming threat might begin to spread, one that could endanger the health of countless innocent lives. The drug was so powerful it was remarkable that any ordinary person could even survive it. There was still so much to uncover—its composition, its origins, the true nature of what it was made from.

The healer omega stretched her legs in quiet frustration. Little Ica shuffled closer, cuddling against her in a small, earnest attempt to comfort. Hyacine let out a slow breath and wrapped her arms around the little guy. They stayed there like that, sitting in a silence that was comfortable, steady.

It was almost curtain-fall hour when her peace broke. The sharp buzz of her teleslate rattled through the courtyard. No doubt another medical emergency concerning the omega still under treatment. But when Hyacine looked at the screen, what she read made her brow furrow, confusion and worry rooting deep in her chest.

When Hyacine arrived at the scene, Okheman soldiers were already stationed at the entrance of the restaurant. A restless crowd had gathered outside, their anxious murmurs spilling into the street, the air thick with the tension of whatever chaos lingered inside.

She hurried in as the guards stepped aside to let her pass, and at once she was struck by the heavy stench of metal… well blood. The sharp tang made her wrinkle her nose as her gaze swept over the room. Her eyes immediately caught the sight of three figures cornered by jagged red crystals. Her frown deepened, but it was the bloodied man on the floor—flanked by two guards, that drew her in.

Hyacine gasped at the sheer brutality left upon his body. Her experienced eyes traced the carnage: his face bore gruesome lacerations, ripped open, skin shredded in grotesque streaks. His eyes were rolled white, pupils nowhere in sight, his mouth frozen open mid-cry—shock carved into his expression as surely as the wounds on his face.

She muttered under her breath as she dropped to her knees, fingers quickly pressing against the man's throat. Her hand trembled for a moment before she found it—a faint, faltering pulse, fragile but there. Relief escaped her in a sharp exhale, but she wasted no time. Her hands lit with practiced movements, weaving healing into flesh, into bone, enough to stabilize him.

Once she was certain he would not die on the floor, she hurried an order to the soldiers: “Take him to the courtyard.” They obeyed, hoisting the broken man away. Only then did Hyacine allow her attention to shift to the ones—duo she had been deliberately ignoring until now.

Carefully, cautiously, she approached.

Mydei, the Undying Prince. An Alpha untouchable, unshaken, never seen faltering before anyone —now sat on the floor stripped of his usual regal poise. His golden eyes were open, yet glazed, unfocused, as though he was caught somewhere between exhaustion and detachment. Hyacine had seen this man injured beyond repair, dragged from battle to battle back to the fullness of his health —yet only a handful of times had she seen the alpha this *exhausted*. This out of it.

Even so, Mydei held the white-haired Alpha in his arms, his protective grip as if he’s hiding him from the watchful gaze.

Phainon was curled against his chest, tucked beneath the prince’s chin, drawn in on himself like something small and wounded. It was also a sight Hyacine had never expected to witness.

And yes, her eyes did caught a glimpse of crimson at Phainon’s fingertips, claws still slick where they clutched desperately at Mydei.

She steadied herself, though her thoughts were already running too quickly, answering questions that she dared not to fill in the gaps herself. Not right now. Not without a proper explanation. The smell of blood still clung heavy in her sensitive nose.

“Lord Mydei,” Hyacine said softly, steadying her tone, though a faint tremor betrayed her unease. She could not begin to piece together what had happened here.

No answer came. The prince sat motionless, still cradling Phainon as though the world itself was barred from reaching them.

She tried again, stepping abit closer.

“Lord Mydei—”

A low growl rumbled answered instead.

Mydei couldn’t remember how he ended up on the floor, or when exactly the soldiers had hurried in. What he did remember was Phainon clinging onto him—the sting behind his eyes, the pounding headache that refused to fade, his skull throbbing in time with his racing heart. His thoughts were too clouded, too muddled, yet he had managed to stop, just a second too late—when the Alpha from the mated pair earlier tried to run away, despite Mydei clearly warning them not to.

He remembered the red crystals bursting, stopping more than one individual in their tracks. But truthfully, he hadn’t cared. Everything had been too much—the scents, the noises, all of it gnawing

at his senses. The only thing he wanted was the man in his arms, hidden away from the chaos, sheltered from these grating sounds that clawed at his mind.

And somewhere along the line, he had slid down onto the floor. The Okheman soldiers had barged in. They had tried to confront him—or *did they? Did he shoo them off? Did they hesitate when no reply came?* He couldn't quite recall.

Everything felt too much.

Almost… uncomfortable.

Yet, despite the haze, his focus never strayed from the man in his arms. Still, his mind wasn't all with him—odd. Usually he had control. He prided himself on being capable, more than capable. Was it the earlier events wearing him down, or something else entirely? He couldn't tell.

All he knew was he hadn't even registered when Hyacine came in, calling for him.

Until

"Lord Mydei—"

A low growl rumbled against his chest.

Not from him.

The sound snapped him from his haze instantly. Mydei's eyes widened in realization just as the man on his lap moved, almost snapping his head back. Mydei grabbed a fistful of white hair and forced him down before he could lash out, wincing when sharp teeth dug into his shoulder.

Bitten… This little savage.

The rumbling growl didn't falter, nor did the slight struggle in his arms. But Mydei's grip didn't waver either. He held firm, the man pressed tightly against him.

With a tired sigh, he glanced at the shocked Omega standing in front of him.

"I'm sorry, Hyacine, but please stay a step back—"

His words cut off in a hiss as the bratty Alpha on his lap clawed his back, nails digging in hard enough to sting. Mydei smacked him lightly with his free hand, earning a growl himself.

HKS.

Hyacine nodded, stepping back, though hesitation still painted her face. Mydei swallowed down the urge to bite, to calm Phainon the way he should—to make the struggling Alpha behave. But poor Hyacine didn't need to see all that.

Whatever helplessness showed in his expression must have been enough, because Hyacine suddenly darted off, then came rushing back with something clutched in her hand.

A syringe.

Oh.

Well, that would be helpful.

So Mydei tightened his hold on Phainon, hugging him with a force the man had likely never experienced in his entire life—tight enough to nearly knock the breath out of him. The Alpha writhed, but Mydei didn't relent.

The healer omega, skilled as she was, didn't waste a second. Swift and precise, she sank the needle into Phainon's neck. Both she and Mydei braced at once when their fellow Heir gave a broken whimper, a small sound that slipped out before he sagged against Mydei, finally going limp.

A beat passed.

Only when Mydei was certain Phainon was out cold did he finally loosen his hold, releasing a breath he hadn't realized he was holding. Still alert, still tense—but able to breathe.

Hyacine sank to the floor beside him with a soft exhale, just as exhausted as he was. Catching the doubt lingering in his eyes, she offered him a tired, reassuring smile.

"Oh, don't worry, Lord Mydei. These are specially made knock out even the strongest Chrysos Heirs," she said innocently, waving the syringe like it wasn't anything alarming. "It should keep him asleep for the next few hours."

Mydei glared at the syringe. As innocent and caring as Hyacine was, she had the same unnerving way of explaining things as Anaxagoras—like she hadn't just admitted she carried sedatives strong enough for Heirs in her pocket. But who was he to complain? She had every right.

Adjusting the sleeping Alpha on his lap, Mydei shifted him carefully, making him presentable for the healer's inspection. He gently laid Phainon onto the floor but kept the man's head resting on his lap, his hand running absentmindedly through the ragged mess of white hair.

Hyacine moved quickly again, examining wounds and assessing any damage the unconscious Heir might have sustained. Her eyes lingered on a fresh bite mark just below the sun tattoo—so faint she might have missed it if the slightly torn shirt collar hadn't revealed it.

She caught herself staring too long, only for Mydei's scoff to cut through.

"That man," he said before she could ask, "that lowlife tried to find an opening by biting down." His tone was sharp, disgusted, as his gaze flicked away toward the obvious bloodstains on the marble floor. His hand, however, stayed possessively caressing the white hair between his fingers.

"It led to this."

His words confirmed Hyacine's earlier speculation, and then he continued, voice edged with a bitter laugh.

"That man might also be our prime suspect." He laughed again, though it sounded hollow—mad, almost. Everything was oddly out of place, a chaos he couldn't untangle, yet here he was, sitting cross-legged on the floor, explaining all of it like a madman. As much as he wanted that man gone from his sight, right now there were bigger issues. Damaging issues. And unfortunately, they involved keeping that bastard alive.

“Do try to keep him alive.”

From me he didn’t quite add.

Phainon woke up strangely groggy. He felt like he’d just come out of a long dream, but also like he’d been run over by ten sprinting Dromas. And unlike his usual terrors, the dream had been… comforting? Unnaturally so. He couldn’t quite recall any of it right now. Anyhow it didn’t change the fact that he felt like absolute shit. His entire body was heavy, achy in places he couldn’t pinpoint, but he needed to get up and look at the time.

Blinking blearily, he tried to chase off the sleepiness. He shouldn’t be slacking like this. He needed to get up.

Except—when he tried to sit, something yanked him straight back down.

It felt like he was being held down.

He squinted, still half-asleep.

Now that he was actually looking, not really but the room didn’t look like his. The structure was similar, sure, but the interior was completely different. Neater. Don’t get him wrong—he was usually neat too, he just…didn’t always have the time to clean up, that’s all.

And most importantly—*what the hell was this thing keeping him from standing up?*

He tried again, but the strong grip only made him fall onto his side, his head hitting the pillow with an off. Slowly, trying to shift around, his surroundings began registering—the warm air brushing over his nape, the way his back awkwardly pushed into something warm and solid. He froze when he heard a low, incoherent huff, the grip around him tightening. Then came the block of heat pressed fully into his back. And worse—something warm and wet dragged against the back of his neck, making him shiver.

And then, bit by bit, the haze cleared enough for the horrifying realization to set in. There was indeed something behind him.

No—*someone* behind him. On the *bed.*

His brain snapped awake at once. Panic tried to bloom. Looking down in disbelief, he found a muscular arm draped across his clothed torso, pinning him firmly. His eyes darted further and nearly bulged out of his head—his thighs. His bare thighs. He wouldn’t have even noticed if it weren’t for the chill of air licking at his skin.

He stared longer than he should, confirming in horror that he was, in fact, not wearing anything down there. Thankfully, the long grayish shirt he was in covered just enough to preserve some dignity.

Focus, Phainon.

Focus.

The arm around him looked…familiar. Too familiar. Red markings stretched across the muscled forearm, and he only knew one man alive with markings like that. The very arm he often drooled—admired.

The arm of the Kremnoen prince.

He inhaled sharply, sniffing the room.

Undeniably, it was the scent of the undying Alpha, Mydeimos. His rival, his sparring partner and his friend.

The very Alpha currently pressed against his back, nose buried against his neck, breathing evenly—peacefully unaware. Meanwhile, Phainon was doing everything in his power not to lose it completely.

Do not panic, Phainon.

This could just be a dream.

Just another one of those rut-dreams. Like all the others where a single encounter with the Alpha left him restless, rutting against his sheets unraveling like a—

He bit his lip hard enough to sting. The pain didn't ground him. Didn't calm the turmoil spiking higher by the second.

Because this was not a dream.

For half a heartbeat, his brain scrambled for some insane explanation. Maybe this was one of those scenarios out of Castorise's borrowed novels—those ridiculous stories where people were whisked away to alternate realities designed to fulfill their deepest, filthiest desires.

He mentally smacked himself.

No. Idiot. He could clearly see the Dawn Device lit, hovering in plain sight beyond the cracked window. He was still in Amphoreus.

And somehow in Mydei's bed.

Between Mydei's arms.

Reeking of Mydei's scent.

Face burning, a million thoughts running through his head—the smell of Mydei's strong scent wasn't helping at all. Head feeling heavy he asked himself:

What happened?

Why was he half-naked?

Why was he in Mydei's bed?

Why wasn't he screaming bloody murder?

His scent must have shifted, traitorous and betraying him—because the grip around him tightened again, Mydei's body sliding impossibly closer until there was no space left. Phainon squirmed, trying to shift, but the arm was iron, unrelenting.

He dared to crane his neck, just enough to glimpse the Alpha. But the moment he moved, the hand at his stomach shifted—pressing firmly down over his lower stomach that—

"Nghh—!?"

The embarrassing sound ripped from him before he could stop it. He slapped a hand over his mouth, face flaming.

The hand stilled.

Phainon froze, mortified. In the small motion of turning, his bare ass brushed back against something—something warm. He didn't want to think about it. Couldn't. His face burned so hot it might as well combust.

Kaphale, why must it be this awkward. He just woke up!

And now, he meets the familiar pair of gold eyes. Awake. Staring right at him.

Another unfamiliar, pathetic noise left his throat before he could choke it back.

Chapter End Notes

Well he's awake! *claps by myself*

Phai suffering in embarrassment begins!

And guys it still crack! Phew… Hehe so more shit and fluff to come. I'm trying to keep the story from going in too deep but it still does barely reminding myself to keep it low… pfft—

Anyways Thank you for reading!

+ sadly yes this fic is still PG!

laughs and runs away

Chapter 6: Awake

Chapter Summary

> “Bite me”

Chapter Notes

> Hello!
>
> Im back—quick again! + Idk if this once’s short or not (I hope not)
>
> I haven’t replied to any comments, I didn’t get the chance to look at them properly I’ll get to them quick
>
> And wows 1k Kudos Tysm (I’m literally just writing stuff up to kill my free time I’m glad y’all are liking it truly 😭❤️)
>
> Some CW⚠️
> •Blood and Injury
> •Self-Harm… (I’m sorry)
> •Instinct Overdrive
> •Usual Unhinges
>
> I can’t recall what more is there but major CWs are all here.
>
> Might be ooc but it’s abo so let me have fun with it—
>
> Just realizing I’m just writing a almost sick fic—?😭 an excused for as a whole abo fic—honestly this fic only supposed to have two chapters but here we are in chapter 6 lmao
>
> Anyways Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Phainon held his breath, still caught in the stare. Gold met blue, sharp and unblinking, and for a second he thought Mydei was wide awake, fully aware of what just happened. But then—no. Something was off. Those eyes weren’t sharp at all. They looked hazy, distant, a faint red bleeding into the gold.

“Mydei?” Phainon frowned, his gut twisting when he received no answer.

He shifted, trying to ease himself away—but the smallest motion was all it took. In a blink, he was flipped, manhandled onto his back, Mydei's weight bearing down. A sharp slam of palm against the mattress caged him in, one hand on either side, leaving Phainon staring up at him, breath caught.

Gulping, Phainon's eyes held the stare for a moment before reality came crashing in as his gaze drifted downward. As much as he'd like to keep up the staring contest, the fact was—he was still bare down there, and the damn shirt (probably Mydei's), the thin layer of clothing he wore at the moment, wasn't built for being thrown around. Which meant the cloth had revealed far more than he'd like.

Flushing from pure embarrassment, his hands flew on instinct to cover his dignity. But Mydei caught on instantly, grabbing his wrists and pinning them flat on either side of his head.

Phainon let out a small gasp, struggling, but his body felt heavier than usual. Uneasy. Unsteady. Too shaken to properly fight back against the man above him.

He gave a huff of disbelief, voice caught between anger and panic. "Mydei, you—"

The words got stuck in his throat.

Because Mydei's face was lowered. Dangerously close—too close—for comfort. Phainon felt ragged breaths ghost against his skin, heat washing over his face. And Mydei's eyes—titans, those were the same eyes he only saw when they sparred. When they lost themselves in the heat of battle. That gaze. Intense. Predatory.

Was Mydei trying to beat his ass here?

On the *bed?*

Right now?

What?

Phainon didn't know. But the moment the Alpha leaned impossibly close, right up to his face, he turned his head sharply, eyes squeezing shut, bracing for the worst.

He's going to die, isn't he?

This was it.

Phainon, what had you done this time to make Mydei angry enough to kill you on the spot?

Oh, Kaphale, why must his life end here?

His life been short.

He still had so much to do.

Yet his miserable one-sided demise short lived as what he imagined never came.

Instead, Phainon snapped his eyes open at the sudden tickle on his neck.

The Alpha had nuzzled into his neck.

Blinking, confused, he stilled. Feeling the way Mydei's nose pressed against his skin, and then the air shifted—flooded with the sharp, smoky scent of sandalwood, thick and cloying, like it wasn't already suffocating the room.

Phainon tried to move, but the weight above him held him trapped. The scent was overwhelming, dizzying. And before he could stop himself, he had whimpered, almost arching against the bed trying to move. In a futile attempt to put distance between himself as the tickling press of Mydei's nose and breath, he accidentally bared his neck. Unknowingly.

And then came a low satisfied rumble.

Instead of filling him with awkwardness or discomfort, the sound left him—strangely content. Inexplicably.

Huh…?

He should be mad furious for being handled like this.

His Alpha's pride should've been ushered to shreds!

But then why was he happy that Mydei sounded satisfied?

The nose trailed its way up, brushing along his jaw, to his face. Lips ghosted against his skin—soft, grazing touches that sent shivers racing down his spine. Every nerve lit up. The Alpha's grip on his arms was like iron, unyielding, immovable.

Shamelessly, Mydei rubbed against his cheek, nuzzling impossibly closer.

And he heard another low rumble.

Phainon was so distracted by everything—the weight, the scent, the warmth—that he didn't even register it at first.

Was Mydei… purring?

But to his horror, it wasn't Mydei who was purring.

The sound was coming from his own chest.

Phainon blinked, stunned, unable to begin processing what was even happening. Mydei's face was still buried against his own, like some satisfied cat, and worse—he himself was enjoying it. He didn't know how it had gotten to this point, how much he'd missed, how much he couldn't piece together. His reactions were all wrong, all odd.

But he had to push the questions aside. Right now, there was only one priority: he needed Mydei to wake up.

So, as bravely as his shaky, dry voice could manage, he whispered:

"Mydei…?"

He prayed the words would reach him.

But luck ran thin.

Nothing.

No response. Only the drag of Mydei's nose sliding along his jaw.

"H-hey—snap out of it." Phainon nudged him gently with his face, desperate to jolt him back.

This time, he did get a reply.

A low growl.

Phainon swallowed hard, praying the man wouldn't accidentally tear his throat out. He tried again, firmer, voice breaking,

"Mydei—hey, wake up, you—"

He cut off with a sharp gasp.

Because Mydei had licked him.

The Alpha's tongue pressed against his neck, leaving behind wet heat.

Phainon's thoughts scattered. His body heated, reacting unconsciously to every touch.

This—this wasn't working.

He shifted again, but this time testing the weight holding him down. His arms were useless, pinned, but his legs—his legs were free. Barely.

Good.

Ignoring the way his clothes shifted, baring more than he'd ever want, he wrapped his legs around Mydei's waist. He could worry about decency later. For now—he needed leverage.

He flexed, muscles straining, grip tightening around the Alpha's waist. Gathering every scrap of strength left in his body, he shoved. Hard.

And just like that, the tables turned.

Phainon forced Mydei onto his back, pinning him down, arms finally freed. The Alpha huffed beneath him, dissatisfied, hands twitching like claws ready to seize prey again.

But before he could, Phainon went for the only solution that came to mind in that instant.

He gripped Mydei's shoulders hard, threw his head back, and slammed their foreheads together.

Praying—desperately—that it would wake the Alpha up.

The impact was harder than it should've been. He even heard a soft crack, hoping it was nothing brutal as it sounded as stars exploded across his vision.

A few beats passed as he rested his forehead on Mydei's, trying to clear the dark spots. Then slowly he lifted his head.

Clearing the dots from his vision, which was still blurred a bit, he could make out Mydei's face. The latter also had his eyes shut. And then they slowly opened.

Phainon scanned the face underneath him while breathing heavily.

The gold eyes looked awake again. Clear. The red that had bled through was gone, replaced with the bright, sharp gold he was used to seeing.

They both panted, lungs dragging like the room had no air left to give.

Smiling a bit, he huffed a breathy laugh. "Well good morning to you too, Mydei—"

But then he felt it. Something hot trailing down his forehead. His vision flickering.

He blinked, trying to focus.

He then saw the way those cleared golden eyes from the Alpha under him widened, mouth opening —in shock? In attempt to say something? He didn't know, he couldn't hear it though. Then he saw a small drop of gold landing on Mydei's face. Possibly his. He didn't know—he could barely see it after all.

He might've hit his head a little too hard, he guessed. Because yes, the world was kind of spinning as he heard a faint calling of his name. But it was muffled.

Damn this Kremnoen forehead of his. What was it made of, iron?

Phainon had barely registered the horrified look Mydei had right now. If he could, he would've commented on it, given the snarky remark like 'wasn't fear not mentioned in the Kremnoen dictionary?'—but the words were stuck in his throat.

He smiled faintly instead, giving one last look at those golden eyes.

And then the world blurred into spots, his body collapsing forward before darkness finally embraced him.

When Phainon woke again, he felt lighter than before. Not weighed down, not heavy—honestly, he felt almost too light, like his body wasn't his own.

Slowly, carefully, he blinked open his eyes. The first thing he registered was that he was still in Mydei's bed. Still in Mydei's room. But this time, he was alone, tangled up in the sheets. His head turned, scanning the space, just to be sure. No one. Still, instead of getting up right away, he sank further into the mattress, letting himself breathe and clear his thoughts. He wasn't in a rush. His body needed the pause.

He inhaled taking a deep breathe—and the distant smell of toast and eggs drifted in. His stomach growled instantly, loud and demanding. That familiar tug of hunger hit him like a reminder that, he

needed to eat.

With a tiny shred of courage, he glanced down. Sheets twisted between his legs, messy and wrinkled. But this time—thank Kaphale—he was wearing pants. Pants. Actual pants. He blinked, relief rushing through him in a wave that made his face heat. Mydei must have helped him into them. Silently, Phainon was grateful, though the thought also made him flush even deeper. Mydei had definitely seen him bare, then. He shoved that mortifying thought aside before it could spiral.

Stretching, his muscles strained and popped from sleep, and he jolted upright with a sharp motion —only to immediately groan. His head throbbed, stabbing pain blooming at his temple.

Oh. Right. He hit his head.

His hand lifted to his forehead, wincing when his fingers pressed against a sting. But instead of raw skin, his touch met a patch—a neat white plaster covering the injury.

The sound he made must have been loud, because the next thing he knew, the door slammed open. Mydei barged in, wearing nothing but an apron and a pair of pants, holding a plate piled with food.

Phainon had stared for bit then his face lit up instantly, ridiculously bright. Because Mydei? Domestic? Mydei with food? This was straight out of one of his fever dreams. He actually beamed, a grin tugging wide at his lips as his hands instinctively reached out, grabby and childlike. Still buried in the sheets, he wordlessly asked for it.

The other Alpha huffed, disbelief written all over his face, but he shook his head anyway. He stepped closer, setting the plate on the bed beside Phainon, sitting down at the edge.

But before Phainon could even reach for the food, Mydei had already picked up the fork, scooping a piece, and brought it straight to his mouth. Waiting. Expecting him to open.

Phainon blinked.

The gesture—it was so normal. Something so natural and kind. Something so delicate, thoughtful. If it weren't coming from the Undying Prince, Mydeimos. The same Alpha responsible for countless of Phainon's battered visits to the twilight courtyard after their 'friendly' sparring matches. The same hands holding the fork with such gentleness were the very hands that had thrown him across training grounds like a ragdoll. And yet here he was, feeding him *like a mate.*

Phainon's jaw dropped before he could stop it. And Mydei took it as a cue, promptly shoving the fork into his mouth.

Phainon muffled a sound of protest, but chewed anyway, the taste of eggs spreading across his tongue. Then Mydei calmly went for another piece.

Wait. Wait. Was he hallucinating? Or had he actually get teleported into those alternate realities—straight out of Castorise's novels? Or had he hit his head so hard when they bonked foreheads that now he was losing his mind? Because this—this was bizarre. One of the strangest mornings of his life. The constant whiplash since he'd opened his eyes was making it hard to keep up.

He chewed slowly, swallowing, then turned to glance at Mydei again. The Alpha looked… tired. More tired than Phainon had seen him in a long while.

When Mydei lifted the fork again, Phainon gently shook his head, a small smile tugging at his lips. “Well, thank you, but I can feed myself, if you don’t mind.”

He meant no offense, none at all. But Mydei’s brows furrowed, his head tilting like he was trying to decode the words. Cute. For a second, Phainon wondered if he’d accidentally spoken in a foreign language. Not that he knew many.

He reached for the plate to take it, maybe thank Mydei for his hospitality, when a strong hand suddenly shot up to his face. Mydei’s palm cupped his chin, tilting his head up, holding him steady. And then the distance between them closed, just enough that Mydei could stare straight into his face.

Phainon’s breath stilled. The man’s gaze roamed his features, inspecting, shifting his head with the lightest pressure of his hand, back and forth, observing every detail. Golden eyes locked onto him, sharp and focused, and Phainon flushed hard under the weight of it. They were close. Far too close. And yet, Phainon let him.

Finally, Mydei’s examination ended. His voice broke the silence, even, calm, but with an edge Phainon knew all too well. “You’re awake.”

It was said simply. But Phainon could hear the irritation hidden beneath.

He forced a shrug, offering a sheepish smile. “Awake than ever.” Then, almost embarrassed, he ducked his face away, slipping from Mydei’s grip. “Sorry for… you know, slamming our heads together earlier.”

Mydei’s mouth opened, then closed. Then he huffed. “That’s not what I meant.”

Phainon blinked, confusion knitting his brows. “Huh?”

The Prince sighed, like he had already expected this, his golden eyes flickering down—just for a breath, just for a blink towards Phainon’s neck.

“So you don’t remember anything, I assume.”

Phainon tilted his head. Memory fuzzy, thoughts hazy. He knew something had happened, but the details slipped through him like water. The light throb in his forehead wasn’t helping either.

Mydei waited. But silence was answered enough. His sigh deepened, tired, resigned. At last, he pushed the plate into Phainon’s hands.

“You missed a lot. Eat first. We’ll discuss everything later.” His words trailed off, then his nose wrinkled faintly, his face shaded with the barest hint of pink. “And you need a shower.”

And so their breakfast-in-bed conversation was cut short. It wasn't even breakfast, Mydei corrected him—it was almost past action hour. At that, Phainon nearly choked on his food, halfway ready to bolt from the quarters. Mydei, irritated, soothed him with a remark that Aglaea had granted them some time. Phainon didn't buy it, but sat down anyway.

It was almost going normally, calmly even, with Mydei giving him fresh towels and asking if he needed anything—to Phainon's surprise, how genuinely worried this man was for him for some reason.

"What am I, a child?" Phainon waved him off with a crooked grin, stepping into Mydei's bathroom.

He almost wanted to laugh at the man's tender care, acting like he was made of glass or something. Snorting, but still—something warm bloomed at the care and attention he was getting. It showed how much the other Alpha cared, even though Phainon didn't know why. He was just… happy about it.

Still smiling faintly to himself, he leaned toward the water basin. He meant to splash his face, but his reflection caught him instead.

Unlike Mydei's exhaustion look, his own features only looked clammy. But just below his neck, there was something else—a small square of plaster, probably covering a scratch or cut, Mydei hadn't mentioned it though. His hand hovered over it, hesitant.

Why was he even hesitating? He'd need to take it off before bathing anyway.

Without thinking, he peeled it away. What stared back at him in the mirror was not a scratch. It was a bruise—gold and red, blooming like fire under his skin. His fingers pressed over it lightly, to see if it hurts.

And then—unthinkingly, uncharacteristically—he bared his teeth at his reflection. A sharp hiss slipped past before he grabbed the first thing within reach and hurled it at the mirror. The glass cracked with a jarring sound, splintering his reflection into fragments.

That was foolish.

What was he even doing?

Why was he acting like this?

why is he so impulsive?

His back hit the tiled wall before he even realized he'd staggered. His fingers dug deep into the skin, clawing at the ugly bruise before he could stop himself. Tears pricked his eyes—maybe from pain, but there was something else, too. Sliding down the wall, unable to gather his thoughts, his fingers kept scratching, tearing at the skin, more and more gold blood welling as hot pain shot up his nerves. He gritted his teeth, but for some Titan-damned reason he didn't care. He just wanted this bruise off his skin.

He just wanted it off him. *Off his skin.*

Immediately, the door banged open. Mydei stood there, not even caring to knock. His eyes widened at the cracked mirror—

"*HSK*, what in the—" But the words died on the blonde's throat as his gaze caught the figure curled up on the floor. Worry and shock burst through him as Hyacine's words and the events rushed back into his mind. He sank to the white-haired Alpha's side, grabbing and yanking the bloodied hand away, pulling it firmly toward himself.

"Lord Mydei, are you sure you're alright?"

Hyacine had come to his side while he worked to clear the crystals around the three trapped civilians, carefully lowering the jagged edges enough so they had room to escape. He offered the shaken restaurant owner a somewhat apologetic smile.

The beta woman just waved him off. She was tougher than she looked, like she'd seen worse.

Mydei made sure the mated alpha was arrested by the soldiers for questioning, ignoring the distressed pregnant omega mate who followed after his alpha in tears. Only when the situation was secured did he allow his gaze to shift—to the white haired alpha sleeping in a chair nearby—before turning back to Hyacine's concerned face.

"I'm fine," he said, though he couldn't quite strip the tiredness from his tone.

"Clearly not! Lord Mydei, you look ill," the healer shot back, puffing up in frustration—even knowing full well the undying prince could not possibly fall sick.

Mydei only patted her shoulder. "I'll be fine," he said, flexing his sore muscles and rolling his neck until it cracked. In truth, he felt heavy, hazy, like mud filled his head, with a dull ache behind his eyes. But the poor omega didn't need to hear any of that—she already had more than enough to deal with.

"There's too much happening right now. I'll come to you if I feel worse." He gave her a tired smile before his hand drifted away from her shoulder, pointing toward the alpha asleep in the chair. "I'm more concerned about him."

Hyacine immediately nodded, more concern flickering in her expression. She'd already heard the details of what happened here—though the way she had smiled knowingly and gave him a thumbs-up when he mentioned Phainon's aggression during the biting and claiming made Mydei raise a brow at her suspiciously.

"Be sure to watch for any distress signals from him," Hyacine had murmured, tilting her chin as she studied the sleeping Chrysos heir. "I'm sure he'll wake soon from his subspace. He shouldn't be too affected by the new mark, judging by his reaction… though—" She trailed off, frowning.

"Yes?" Mydei asked, suddenly tense.

"I don't think he'll react badly to the bite once he's conscious—he is an alpha. But…" She looked at Mydei with more seriousness. "Unwanted marks affect people differently, even alphas. And it looks to be a gesture like a bite means a lot to Lord Phainon—well, to his alpha. It's

understandable. But it can be unpredictable." She gestured lightly to the blood still staining the floor.

With a quiet sigh, Hyacine finished,

"Let's observe him for now. Taking care of him is the best way to avoid the worst."

And so the Healer had said. Mydei could only scoff at himself, irritation blooming in his chest for ever letting something like this happen. When he'd seen the Deliverer back to his usual self—awake, talking—he had been foolish enough to think it meant whole. To trust everything would just go back to normal so quickly. He should've known better than to let go so easily, to trust these fragile, miserable instincts of his wouldn't find another way to drag Phainon into more suffering.

Now all he could do was stare in horror at the ugly gash of torn skin, gold dripping down, soaking through the collar of his shirt. His grip tightened around Phainon's wrists, holding them down, desperate to keep him from clawing himself further.

And just as he thought it couldn't get worse—he heard a shaky inhale.

"My… Mydei—" Big blue eyes, with a creeping gold, stared up at him. Pupils shaking, unfocused and confused. "Take it off—"

Mydei tried to call out for him, but the words never had to chance to leave his mouth as Phainon curled further into himself, shaking his head in frantic denial.

"T-take it off—please, take it off—*off of me—please*—TAKE IT OFF!"

The words broke apart into screams and sobs, glassy-eyed pleading that made Mydei's heart twist. He didn't know what to do. He didn't know how to make it stop. This wasn't how it was supposed to go. It should've been normal. Phainon should've been back to normal. Everything should've been back to normal. Mydei should've been more careful. He could've prevented this.

The rage that coiled through his mind wasn't for Phainon. And it wasn't for himself either. It was for that traitorous alpha. The bastard who had done this. When Mydei gets his hands on him, he would be the one choking, the one begging. When Mydei tears his throat apart.

Without a second thought, he shoved the man onto his chest, muffling the cries against himself as he helplessly wished Phainon would find some reassurance, some comfort, in his hold. Mydei's own mind was too conflicted to properly help—too shaken to know what was right. All he could do was hope desperately as he lowered himself fully onto the tiled floor, lifting the taller man onto his lap. A position that, to his shame and relief, they had both somehow grown more comfortable with in the past few days.

Hands still restrained in his grip, Mydei pressed his face toward the bruised, torn skin at Phainon's neck. Then, without thinking, he did the unthinkable—he lowered his head and licked over the wound, slow and deliberate. As if he could clean it with his own mouth. Why? He didn't know. Would it help? He didn't know either. But in the silence of his panic, his instincts drowned out his reason, and he gave himself over to them completely.

Though the scratch marks were deep, they hadn't spread beyond the bruise itself. Phainon had only clawed at the mark, desperate to rip it away, and so Mydei set to work—tongue dragging over the angry skin, carefully, rhythmically, as though each stroke might soothe what words could not. To his disbelief, his instincts were right. He felt the tension in Phainon's hands loosen, the desperate fight bleeding out of him until his wrists went limp in Mydei's hold.

He could feel the other seeking comfort in his touch—willingly, desperately. Mydei didn't care who it was that answered him now, whether it was Phainon or the fragile, furious Alpha buried inside him. All he wanted was to stop the shaky breaths, the broken whimpers tearing out of the man's throat. He ignored the taste of copper and iron as it spread across his tongue, didn't mind it at all, even as the wound stung beneath his mouth.

And then—Phainon bared his neck. Obedient. Offering more space, more access, as though he craved this. Mydei shifted his grip, releasing the man's wrists only to move his own hands—finding the other's hips, grounding himself against him. Phainon's now free hands threaded into Mydei's golden hair, holding tight, as if afraid to let go. Soft, breathy sounds slipped out—moans quiet and unguarded, making heat stir between them in ways that should have modified them both.

Here they were, giving in to their most primal instincts—on a bathroom floor, no less—as Mydei licked and soothed the wounds.

When Mydei was finally done, he hummed low in his chest, content with his work, and began to pull back. Slowly, carefully, he lifted his head, consequences finally crashing over him with brutal clarity.

What had he just done…so shamelessly?

So willingly?

But he didn't get far.

Because Phainon's hands shoved his face back down, forcing his lips against the still-wet skin. Mydei's eyes widened in shock. What more could he possibly want?

Then he heard it.

A shaky breath ghosted over his ear, hot and trembling. Lips brushed clumsily against his skin as Phainon whispered, voice low and broken:

"Mydei."

The sound burned through him, heavy with want, with need. Phainon's hands cradled his head, pulling him impossibly closer.

"*Bite me.*"

Mydei froze. His body stilled, his breath caught. He shouldn't. He really, truly shouldn't. Not after this mess. Not when everything had already spiraled so far beyond control. But the thought—the image—of someone else's mark calming his Deliverer's instincts while his own touch hadn't… It made a rage ignite in him, white-hot, clawing at his chest.

Phainon seemed to sense it, because he immediately soothed him—nosing at his ear, scent wrapping around him sweet and dizzying until his nerves softened, until he couldn't think beyond the haze of it. Fingers caressed his scalp, gentle, addictive, guiding him closer.

"Please." Another whisper.

And then—

"Bite me, Alpha."

The words snapped the last of Mydei's restraint. His mind blurred into instinct, and the next thing he knew, his teeth had sunk deep into the bruised flesh. He didn't care. Didn't think. He only heard the sound Phainon made—an unrestrained, satisfied moan, spilling hot against his ear—and all the tension in the man's body melted.

Phainon arched against him, seeking more, before finally going pliant, molding himself into Mydei's lap. Mydei released him only when he was certain the wound had been sealed, giving it a final lick to stem the blood flow. He had bitten lightly—not deep enough to claim, but enough to satisfy the desperate needy alpha clinging to him. Enough to make the other stop trembling. Enough to bring relief.

For now, the brutal mess of torn skin could be ignored. For now, let his mark linger—temporary, but his.

Mydei lifted his head at last, intent on seeing the expression on the other's face. But Phainon only buried himself deeper into Mydei's neck, hiding.

Mydei frowned at that and nudged him. He wanted to see him. He needed to. But all he got was a muffled noise in return.

He caught the red tint burning across the man's ears.

"Deliverer," Mydei said firmly.

There was a pause. He thought, for a moment, he wouldn't answer. Then surprisingly came a barely audible soft hum.

"Stop hiding like a coward," Mydei pressed. But his voice lacked its usual bite.

Slowly, finally, Phainon shifted. His flushed face lifted, reluctantly, until their eyes met.

And what Mydei saw knocked the breath from him. Not the gold he expected. Not the fractured haze. But clear, bright blue. Wide. Vulnerable.

Lips bitten, eyes darting away like a flustered boy.

Mydei opened his mouth to speak, disbelief thick in his chest—but Phainon groaned first, the reality of what just happened clearly crashing over him. He lifted his hands and covered his face,

still perched in Mydei's lap, now marked with fresh teeth on his neck.

"I can't believe I just asked you to bite me," he squealed, uncharacteristically high-pitched, muffling himself behind his palms.

And then it clicked.

Now it was Mydei's turn to blush.

Chapter End Notes

Mydei reacting to Phainon's Alpha - "Omg I must protec and scent this creature pamper him up with much as care and love in the world eliminate any threat that hurts the loml"

Phainon reacting to Mydei's Alpha - "OMG WHO IS YOU—" *BONK*

Also Phainon's Alpha is literally an Omega but with a rut so bare with him—he's just overdramatic for plot reasons!

a.k.a Me shoving my occ as their 'alphas' so I have an excuse to write them as distressed damsels lol

Ngl this chapter had a nymph in it …all for cuteness and giggles then I realized I was on Phai's POV and—BOOM I got Khaslana flashbacks(ptsd lmao)—The moment I wrote "I only remember a nymph—" I deleted the whole nymph and it's importance to the story immediately ✋😭 Oh hell nah 3.4 is still hunting me…

Also like I apologize for making their blush red and not gold— I find writing golden flush… odd—makes it somewhat look funny in my head. So I'd keep it red.

Bare with my mind it's everywhere—I finished this at 3 am literally so…might be grammer, spelling and phacing issues…idk I'll probably be late again updating next chapter since work is starting soon—my days are numbered— *dies*

Anyways

As Always Thank you for reading, your Kudos and comments!

Chapter 7: Door Bell

Chapter Summary

Two Alphas in a room they might kiss

Chapter Notes

Hellooooooo

I'm so sorry for the late update! Work + me writing 2 more different fics at the same time(who knows why I do this) had me everywhere

Anyways here you go! A short update yaaay!

And a warning! Pls prepare yourself for more questionable stuff done by the duo!

CW⚠️
•Posssesive Behavior
•Mild chocking (it's barely there)
•Blood and more biting ig
•Rutting — Dry Humping / Grinding and yeah slight sexual content—are y'all happy? it's very mild so don't expect anything big

Ummm

Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Phainon collapsed onto the rumpled sheets, chest stuttering with air he couldn't catch. His skin burned where Mydei's mouth had been, the claim pulsing, sweat sticking his shirt to his back.

And then Mydei was over him, pressing him down, golden eyes bleeding red, blown dark with hunger, his breath sharp like he'd been holding it in for days.

They hadn't meant for this. Titans, not here. Not like this.

One second, they'd been on the bathroom floor, after Phainon's small Alpha meltdown. He had only meant to soothe him, to calm his discomfort, his distress. And for that good moment, Mydei had thought it was only Phainon's Alpha begging him—begging him to soothe him. To claim him.

But then he caught the glimpse of clear usual blue eyes peeking out, guilty, like a pup caught doing something he wasn't supposed to. Mydei had seen that look before, in Kremnoen children—the fierce blush, the refusal to meet his eyes, the knowing shame.

The problem was, this wasn't a child. This was a grown man. A full Alpha. Sitting on his lap, making that face.

And Mydei had flushed just as hard.

But what truly embarrassed the man on his lap wasn't just the slip of instinct. It was something Mydei himself had ignored for two days straight.

He had pretended. Pretended not to notice how stiff they both got during their calming scenting sessions, when the air grew thick with pheromones. How much tension that build in between them. How much he had ignored then. To prove his control was stronger than instinct. Stronger than desire. He had pride. He had a name. He would never take advantage. Never let his own hunger dictate his hand. Never do anything without consent.

But this time… the second Phainon—despite that mortified look—bucked back, grinding shamelessly against him, the last thread of his rationality snapped.

Somewhere, he had gave up.

Somewhere, their mouths crashed together—wordless, desperate, teeth and tongue and heat.

Somewhere, they surrendered to the fire that had been gnawing at them for days—maybe longer.

They stumbled out of the bath, still kissing, devouring, swallowing every sound, every shred of shame.

Now—they were here.

Grinding again. Hips crashing together like they wanted to bruise. Their cocks pressed between them, straining through soaked fabric, sliding hot with pre-come that had already bled through both their pants.

Neither of them stopped.

Phainon didn't move away. His face was flushed, teeth gritted, but his hips kept rolling up into Mydei's, shameless in his need. He hated it. He needed it more than air.

They didn't speak. Not one word.

Mydei leaned down and caught the other's lips again hungrily, teeth chasing skin.

No one protested.

Their mouths fought for dominance—biting, sucking, tongues clashing until they were both panting, both wrecked. It was less a kiss than a battle. All teeth and heat, lips sliding wet and reckless against each other. Phainon pushed forward with a growl in his throat, chasing the taste of Mydei like he meant to devour him whole. Every drag of his tongue was demanding, every bite was a warning.

Neither pulled away.

Their teeth clicked, sharp and careless. The sting only spurred them on, made the kisses harder, rougher, desperate to mark, to own. Mydei's lips burned under the assault, slick and raw, but he

refused to yield, meeting Phainon's hunger with his own, pushing back just as fiercely.

Phainon's hands roamed without sense, clutching at Mydei's bare shoulders, fingers digging into hot skin. His palms slid down the ridges of muscle, pulling him closer, nails scraping as if to leave something behind. The sweat on Mydei's back made him slick under his grip, but Phainon clung harder, dragging him down, grounding against him with reckless need.

For a moment, though, Phainon had the edge. He caught Mydei's lip between his teeth, biting down until the sharp snap of pain pulled a sound from him. It was a half-gasp, half-growl. It vibrated against Phainon's mouth, hot and raw, feeding into the smug curl of his smile. He licked over the bite, over the faint copper taste he'd drawn, pressing back in, greedy, tongues colliding in a wet, messy slide that stole the air from their lungs—until Mydei's hand slid higher, wrapping firm around his throat, and squeezed.

The mark there pulsed under his grip. Not enough to hurt.

Just enough to remind him.

Phainon shuddered, a broken sound tearing free, hips jerking upward as if the grip alone unraveled him. His body surrendered before his mouth could form the words.

Mydei growled against his lips, victory rough in his voice, rutting harder now—cocks grinding in a slick, desperate rhythm that made Phainon's head spin.

And Mydei knew they should stop. They might regret this later. It could even make things more awkward between them. But his body wasn't listening. Instead of stopping, his thigh shoved between Phainon's, forcing his legs wider, forcing him open, kneeing the clothed erection.

Phainon whined, head thrown back, throat bared in Mydei's hold. Without pride, without Alpha dignity, just giving in—and Titans, it drove Mydei insane. Only nails dug into Mydei's shoulders, but there was no push, no resistance.

Neither of them said it—that they should stop, that this was reckless.

Their bodies didn't care. Their instincts didn't care.

They were both so hard it ached, cocks straining painfully against the confines of their pants, every grind only making the fabric stick wetter, rougher.

Two Alphas, rutting like they'd tear each other apart if they stopped. Completely wild and primal.

Just instinct and heat, grinding until every breath turned into a ragged moan, until every thrust grew slicker, filthier, until the ache blurred into desperate pleasure.

Phainon's lungs burned as he closed his eyes, the air shuddering in and out of him. Somewhere in the haze of heat and grinding pleasure, he thought he should be furious—humiliated to be handled like some Omega, forced beneath another Alpha's weight. To surrender, to let someone else set the rhythm, drag out the sounds from his throat.

But it wasn't just someone else.

It was Mydei.

And that was the difference.

Because it was Mydei holding him down, Mydei's strength caging him in, Mydei's hands dictating every shiver. Somehow, that made it safe. As horrifying as it should have been, as unthinkable as it would have been with anyone else—he didn't push him away.

And Mydei—Mydei was on the brink of losing himself. His sanity frayed with every rut of his hips, every pulse of heat in his cock. His body felt lighter, freer with each thrust, as if giving in to instinct was healing something broken inside him. Like some kind of switch had flipped—something he had abandoned long ago or never truly acknowledged. A haze that blinded reason.

For that moment, he didn't care. For that moment, he wanted nothing but this.

He forgot everything but desire. Forgot Phainon's shallow breaths, forgot his hand locked on his throat just to keep him there.

All that remained was possession. A feral urge. He was being overtaken by a heat—exactly how an Alpha lost himself in the chaos of battle. A familiar frenzy, yet different all the same. And that same feral undercurrent now burned across his face.

Then, in the distance

A doorbell rang.

Phainon's eyes snapped open, horror curling at the edges of his pleasure. He tried to rasp out a sound, tried to shift, tried to drag Mydei's attention to the noise. The bell rang again—louder this time.

But only the grip on his throat tightened.

And he froze.

Because Mydei didn't react.

Didn't even flinch.

Instead, a feral smile stretched across his face, teeth flashing as his hips ground harder, faster. A growl rolled from his chest as if he could devour the interruption whole. His eyes were dark, red, unrelenting.

And it should have terrified Phainon. That look should have made him shove Mydei off, snarl and break free. But instead, it sent the heat spiking higher. A pathetic whine broke from him before he could stop it.

Mydei's eyes narrowed at the sound, his hips snapping harder as the pace quickened.

Phainon clutched at the hands gripping his throat, desperate, gasping like he couldn't breathe. The rhythm turned punishing, relentless. He opened his mouth, but nothing came out except broken sounds, his nails digging in as the grip on his throat tightened. And strangely, it only pulled him closer to his edge.

Mydei kept his pace, drove into him until their pants were slick with mess, until Phainon's vision blurred.

The coil snapped first in Phainon. His back arched, voice breaking on a strangled cry as his cock spilled hot between them, soaking his pants.

Mydei followed with a growl, hips jerking, teeth bared in a silent snarl of bliss. He kept grinding them through the aftershocks until their bodies ached—until it became uncomfortable.

They came undone together.

Panting. Trembling. The hand on his throat retreated, leaving bruises that he's sure would linger for days.

The doorbell still echoed faintly. But for a moment, it was just them.

Mydei braced over him, chest rising and falling like a war drum, eyes fading back to gold as he licked his bitten lips.

Phainon could only stare back—flushed, head empty, lips swollen, pants sticking uncomfortably.

Khepale,

They had just done that.

Hyacine half expected no response, and she'd already thought of leaving after ringing the doorbell for the eighteenth time.

But, proving her wrong, the door slid open just a crack. A single golden eye glared out, tired and bloodshot. She immediately stepped in with concern—only to stop as she pinched her nose when the scent hit her: a strange mix of two familiar Alpha pheromones, poorly masked by soap. Like someone had taken a shower and hoped it would wash the evidence away. It hadn't.

Not to her nose.

She just blinked.

"What are you doing here, Hyacine?" Mydei asked at last. His voice was scratchy, ragged, like he hadn't spoken for hours. Rough enough to make her concerned before she was even suspicious.

Right then, Hyacine only stared. He still hadn't opened the door fully, which was odd—Mydei was usually warm and welcoming. But now, he kept glancing back into his quarters, looking almost anxious, like he was hiding something.

Her lips pressed into a thin line. Then, after a beat, she spoke. "Don't you remember? I asked you to come by the Courtyard. Since you didn't show up, I came here myself." She waved her bag for emphasis.

Mydei's eyes widened, like he was remembering something important. He glanced back again, almost debating whether to shut the door right then and there.

Instead, he muttered, “Can I come to the Courtyard later?”

It was the wrong thing to say. Hyacine had rearranged her schedule, adjusted all her work, because she was concerned about the duo more than anything. And Mydei should have known that. He did know—but he couldn’t let her in, not right now. Not when he looked like a mess himself. And most importantly—not with the other Alpha inside. He did *not* want to explain.

But the little Omega grumbled under her breath, launching into a lecture about the importance of proper healthcare, her hand firmly wedged against the doorframe, stubbornly insisting on coming in.

Mydei realized there was no escaping this.

He sighed tiredly before finally opening the door. “Just… brace yourself,” he warned.

The thick, mixed scent of two Alphas hit her full force, and Hyacine immediately stepped back outside. Mydei raised a brow, but she dug into her bag, pulled something out, clipped it over her nose, and stepped back in like this was just another day. Mydei didn’t question her further, just led her to the living room.

Hyacine thanked him as she sat on the keelin, taking notes as she always did. Mydei looked worse than before—tired, shoulders hunched, hair dripping from a hasty shower, clothes half-damp, and, most unusual of all, wearing a plain shirt. Mydei usually tried to stay composed, especially in front of others. So it was very concerning. But what caught her attention most was his mouth. Red, bitten lips. She hadn’t noticed at the door, but now, seeing him in full light, it looked awful. Like someone had chewed on them.

Mydei noticed her stare. He crossed his arms and cleared his throat loudly.

Hyacine opened her mouth to speak—but another voice cut in.

“Mydei, who’s—”

Phainon stepped into view and froze.

Unlike Mydei, who wore only a shirt, Phainon had bundled himself from neck to ankle in layers clearly stolen from Mydei’s closet. He looked ridiculous—wrapped up like a burrito, presumably to hide his neck. Wrapped in random Kremnoen wear Mydei didn’t even know he had. Mydei almost laughed—but the fact that Phainon was wrapped in *his* clothes didn’t help his already frayed instincts. He forced himself to stay controlled—for Hyacine’s sake.

Phainon stood there, short-circuiting, face heating up. Hyacine just waved casually, then frowned. Her gaze darted from Mydei, to Phainon, then back again, like she was piecing a puzzle together in her head.

Phainon bit his already bitten lips and shot Mydei a helpless look, silently begging for rescue from the Omega’s judgment.

Mydei only slumped back in his seat.

There was going to be a long, painful explaining process.

Chapter End Notes

It’s short but next update will be soon do dw

and some um mild stuff so we could dive more deep into what more is to come… You know I didn’t just add a random villain for nothing ehehehe— He might stir more heat hehe bc Mydei alr is losing it (I wonder why)

Ngl but I can only imagine two alphas kissing nothing but brutally eating and biting each other out like lol

And this image was stuck inside my brain the whole scene what a turn off. Idk I kept giggling…
https://x.com/possiblydog609/status/1662653863931912192?s=46
(This but as Phaidei/Myphai)

Anyways

I’ll explain more on what might’ve happened while Hyacine waited outside bc it was just the half the picture

I just wanted to leave an update soon that’s alll

Ty for reading ! Bye—

Chapter 8: Fever

Chapter Summary

Some scenes before Mydei answered the door.

And some talk.

Chapter Notes

Hellooo

This one took longer then I thought to finish sighhh, we have a explanation well mostly—

umm prepare yourself

First half will be Phai and his unhelpful narrating…he's somewhere between down bad and denial so bare with him.

And then there's sum mild smut too uhhh…

Then finally we'll get the explanation part!

So CW⚠️
•Possessive behavior
•Unhinged and usual madness
•Downbad morified stuff
takes a deep breath
•Hand jobs
•Explicit Language
•Mild dirty talk
•Light dom/sub undertones(it literally non existent but there)
•Explicit/Sexual Content(still mild)

Anyway

Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Phainon was sure Mnestia must be pranking him.

Can you blame him? Ever since he woke up, nothing had made sense. For instance, like being wrapped up in Mydei's scent. In Mydei's bed. In Mydei's clothes. In Mydei's plush, strong, muscled arms—on top it all half-naked! which really shouldn't be mentioned again at all. Damn

this narrative. He had, in fact, woken to a sight pulled straight out of his filthiest—well, a more tamed version of his fever dreams.

And the fact that he doesn't remember how he ended up in that situation in the first place.

His memory only provided him with an unhelpful reminder that he should be mad furious—about a random bruise on his neck. Which he still doesn't know how it happened.

All he knew was that he had fallen apart over it. Pathetically. Begging, embarrassing himself, unraveling before his—no, not his alpha, his rival. The man who treated him as an equal. The one Phainon himself liked to tease, to bicker—to admire, though he would never admit that part out loud. Someone whom he never wanted to look weak infront of. Someone who consider him to be worthy enough to stand beside in battle.

Yet—he had begged that same alpha in his unexplained panic, made that same alpha comfort him. And to his surprise, the other did. So willingly. Without hesitation. Exactly how a hidden, aching part of Phainon had longed for, though he hadn't known until then. The moment had wrapped him in safety, in warmth, in something so deep his body had buzzed with it.

He should've been humiliated.

His inner alpha should've torn free from that grasp and fought for his pride, as he should have.

He should be furious for letting himself be comforted by an alpha he sought competition from. An alpha he loved to challenge.

But his inner alpha was overjoyed. As if this was all they had ever wanted, as if they had finally found what they had been searching for. Like they had figured it out all on their own—without Phainon even knowing. How dare they!

A doorbell rang.

And his pants felt sticky and uncomfortable as ever.

But nothing could be heard clearly; everything was muffled by his foggy mind and that rumbling. What was that again? Ah, yes—the purring.

There was another sound. A mouth hummed against his skin, wet, hot licks and breath tracing dangerously close to where his sun tattoo burned on his neck. The hotness of breath made every nerve in his body light up. It was a completely unfamiliar feeling. And the skin was sensitive there, so it wasn't Phainon's fault that he made a needy noise he couldn't quite name.

The door bell rang…

His mind was somewhere else. The heat of the breath, the tickling sensation, made his body work on its own. The way he was caged against this big strong furnace of heat, the way his hips rocked again, the way his hands clung to the head buried in his neck, the way he eagerly gave more access to explore his most unguarded, most sensitive part—it wasn't his fault. He couldn't control it at all.

The doorbell—"*oh*", a soft sound left his lips as the mouth picked a very sensitive spot at his neck. He knew he would be extra sensitive there, considering his alpha had earlier bruised it with a strong grip that had kept him from misbehaving—Another sound tore from Phainon's throat, louder than he meant as his alpha-his Mydei-licked over the mark that was still tender, still raw where it had barely healed.

It smelled heavenly here. Mydei's scent wrapped around him, warm and *safe*, barely letting his own shine through. As if it was only for Mydei. What a greedy alpha his alpha was. But again instead of being angry, like he was supposed to be, he only wanted to be buried in this strong musk and just stay like this. Away from the responsibility away from weight of the world.

His own mouth found the heated ear of his alpha and licked it in delight.

The doorbell rang again.

They should really answer that—

Phainon whined, nipping at his alpha's ear, fingers threading carefully through the golden locks. He wanted to rock his hips again, but his alpha wasn't allowing it—his hips were trapped under the weight of the other's thighs. He squirmed. Mydei only growled in response.

The doorbell rang once more. Still, it was barely audible over that annoying rumbling.

Phainon's glazed eyes blinked blankly at the ceiling. A hand roamed his body. He should probably stop it. It slid lower and lifted his thigh—too high—luckily his flexibility allowed it or this position would've been uncomfortable.

The loose pants he wore slid down his leg enough to expose his bare thigh. He should probably stop that too. Then the hand slid inside, gripping his thigh, then rubbing in odd slow motions.

What was even Mydei trying to do? his muddy brain did ask.

Because what a laughable position they were in. He wanted to remind this hungry, heated alpha above him that his pants were still too sticky wet and gross. It should've been for both of them. But here they were.

The doorbell rang—

but the rumbling between their chests was louder.

Kephale, who was purring so loud?!

Phainon's displeasure rose at the sound, but just as he was about to crash out about his distress…it stopped. He blinked at nothing. And then, in his half-daze brain, he came to the shocking realization that it had been coming from him all along.

What was wrong with him.

Now that was out of the way, he should probably remember something else. He could still feel Mydei bending his leg down, the grip on his thigh bruising and seemingly testing his flexibility.

“Mydei…” he managed to murmur, still dazed. The pants were beyond uncomfortable now, the way they pressed with his thigh lifted. That wasn’t what—there was something else he should remember…

Mydei answered with a low rumble, something like a hum against his neck. His breath was unusually hot that—

Focus Phainon

There was somthing else…

He felt like they were ignoring something…

And so the *doorbell* rang.

Ah. *That.*

One of Phainon’s hands broke away from Mydei’s hair to reach the other’s face. Concerning amount of feverish heat pulsed under his palm as he tried to lift it.

The other made a displeased sound at that, but lifted just enough to nuzzle into Phainon’s palm, which must be cooler compared to his own burning face and body.

“Mydei,” he whispered again. He didn’t know why he whispered, but something told him it was right. The alpha leaning into his palm didn’t respond. Only licked his hand, slow, hot, wet, like a lion tasting its meal first. It sent a shiver through him at the absurdity.

Right…his Mydei wasn’t fully here, his unhelpful mind provided.

The other Alpha had stubbornly leaned into his palm, looking exactly like a big chimera. He would’ve joked, but the thought died when the alpha opened his eyes.

Mydei’s gaze was heat-hazed. His face feverish. Staring at him, but not fully present.

The doorbell rang again. Mydei looked as if he didn’t hear it. Or just didn’t care.

“Mydei,” he tried again.

But the blond only stared, blinking slowly, almost sleepily. A flash of red tinted the usual golden eyes.

Phainon tried again, this time

“…*Alpha*?”

That got a reaction. Mydei didn’t answer with words, but let go of his thigh, grabbed his hand instead, and nipped at his fingers—light bites, then small licks, cradling it close to his face.

Phainon’s brain did something that made a shiver run down his spine and felt his heart run few laps.

He really should call out, or joke—the man before him was acting like a baby chimera right now.

But his own face heated up instead.

This was the first time Mydei looked at him like that. Like… so devoted? almost innocently…?, no tension, just staring like… some big feline.

Phainon opened his mouth but nothing came out, it was probably because he didn't want his hand bitten off. That—and maybe because he was a coward and is not ready to address the situation they were in right now.

Not yet. Not out loud. He wasn't even sure he could. And he was oddly relieved that Mydei hadn't thrown him out, yet. For some reason.

So, instead, he said

"Somebody is at the door."

It took a moment but surprisingly that seemed to wake Mydei from whatever fever haze he was in. He blinked a few times, then flinched? pulling away from Phainon, who was still pinned to the bed by the alpha's weight.

"I-" Mydei uncharacteristically stuttered, struggling to form words as he stood. He winced, finally addressing the sticky mess inside his pants.

The doorbell rang again.

Mydei paused for a long time, gathering his thoughts, while Phainon took his time too, sitting up from the bed.

Then Mydei decided. He grabbed Phainon without hesitation without a word and dragged them both toward his bath.

Phainon protested immediately, stopping at the bathroom door, face heating up all over again—but he didn't break eye contact when the other alpha looked back at him.

Because surely…surely he should be realize about what mess they were about to clean up in there right?

"I can shower myself!" he snapped. But Mydei only grumbled, pointing at the mess on the bathroom floor.

Phainon looked at the shattered mirror, then at Mydei, an apology building at his throat—but,

"I'm not letting you alone again," Mydei gritted out. And then proceeded to drag Phainon inside without a care.

The two of them stood back to back under the hiss of cold water, marble tiles catching fractured reflections of bare skin. It should have been a quick shower. But the air was thick with their scent, stubbornly clinging to their throats, and the sounds Mydei made behind him weren't helping—Phainon's body betrayed him all over again.

And judging from the growl that rumbled from behind, Mydei wasn't faring much better.

You see, they both had tried to shower and clean themselves—as mature alpha adults who didn't want anything more awkward happening between them.

But the problem was, no matter how long they stood under that cold shower, their sudden stiffness wasn't going down.

And they needed to hurry.

And a relief.

So whatever reckless Titan possessed him in that moment, Phainon blurted out, "Need help?"

Silence stretched. Long enough that he nearly drowned himself in the shame of asking, half-prepared to laugh it off. But then,

"…What are you offering?"

Mydei asked, smug and almost amused, as if the Alpha hadn't just been caught suffering the same struggle.

Phainon cursed him silently.

He shrugged, uselessly, since his back was still turned. "I don't know. Maybe a challenge?" His voice cracked on the last word, betraying him, and he hated that it only made his pulse thrum harder.

They really should hurry. Someone could still be waiting outside.

And this was an option, *so*-

A hum came, as if the other knew what he was implying on, considering.

Then he felt Mydei shift. A shiver ran down his spine. But he didn't turn all while Mydei made his way slowly, closing the distance. Without warning, he felt a solid press of a body slotting against his back.

Phainon should shove him away.

He shouldn't be humiliated more than he already has, right?

Well, he didn't do anything but stand.

And Titans—Mydei was burning. Even with the water running cold, Mydei's heat seared into him. Something thick and warm pushed against him, dragging another shiver up his spine.

“What are your conditions?” Mydei’s voice curled against his ear, velvet wrapped around steel. Like a different man entirely.

“There’s… nothing,” Phainon managed. He knew he should probably set some boundaries. He knew he was going to be more humiliated letting Mydei take control like this.

Then why was he not wording it?

Phainon really should get a grip, he was losing already.

A chuckle followed. It was low and satisfied. Phainon almost purred at it, then mentally smacked himself because his dignity was washing away just like the water running down at their feet.

Then he felt Mydei’s hand slide forward,

‘*What was he planning*’, White haired alpha still had the guts to wonder.

The hand wrapped around Phainon’s length just as Mydei’s own pressed harder from behind, sliding between the tense grip of the other’s thighs.

Phainon had nearly buckled. His eyes dropped in disbelief as he stared down between his thighs. Because this was wrong—the way Mydei’s inhuman cock had just emerged between his thighs, right under his own.

Phainon wouldn’t lie; he had seen Mydei’s bare manhood a couple of times during their trips to the baths. He had thought they were roughly the same size. But oh, how he had underestimated. That soft cock had been something, but between his bare thighs, the hard one was a monster. While his own was significantly large, mind you, it looked pathetic next to Mydei’s.

“Mydei, your—” he started, but was suddenly cut off as he was shoved against the cold marble.

The cold spray hit his skin, but Phainon barely felt it—his whole world narrowed to the drag of Mydei’s hand around him, the relentless push from behind. His forehead pressed against the wet marble, gasping as every nerve burned.

“Mydei—” The words tumbled out, unsteady, breaking into a moan when the other’s grip tightened just right. His hips bucked helplessly into Mydei’s fist, no rhythm of his own left, only following while his tried to keep quivering thighs together.

Behind him, Mydei’s mouth brushed the tender mark on his neck, lips dragging over still-sore, healing skin. The scrape of teeth made Phainon shudder so hard he nearly slipped.

“Cheater,” Phainon croaked against the tile.

“Mine,” Mydei murmured against the mark, smug, his breath hot even under the cold water. Seemingly happy that Phainon didn’t even correct his slip.

Instead, Phainon groaned, forehead digging into the tile, hands scrabbling for purchase. “Unfair—*ah*.” His voice broke into a moan when Mydei’s hand twisted.

“You like it.” Mydei’s voice was low, frayed, but steady with a cruel confidence. ‘*Why was he so damn cocky while he was also barely holding it together?*’ Phainon’s thoughts did rang from somewhere…Mydei’s thrusts grew rougher, cock sliding hard between Phainon’s thighs, grinding against him. “Clinging to the wall like this… letting me use you”

Another sound tore from Phainon—a whine, *humiliating*. His chest dragging against the slick, cold stone as he lost control. His release hit suddenly and violently, spilling hot across the tile as his whole body trembled.

A whimper followed, muffled by the wall he pressed his face into, body convulsing as he came undone in his Alpha’s hand.

Mydei didn’t stop. He grind in harder, chasing his own edge, pressing Phainon tight into the marble as if he could fuse them there. His growl rose into a ragged moan, hot breath at Phainon’s ear, before he finally spilled against him—thick, hot, claiming, his hips stuttering as the last of his control snapped.

Pinned there, trembling and ruined, Phainon barely had the strength to lift his head. Mydei’s weight was still heavy at his back, hand firm on his hip.

They felt as if they were almost forgetting something…

Right…there was someone at the door.

Mydei had cursed something in Kremnoen.

In a haste they had stumbled out of the bathroom—well, Mydei did, Phainon was dragged along. He rushed to put on some decent clothes, noting the ugly scratch marks from way earlier that still hadn’t quite healed.

And the doorbell still rang, surprisingly.

Mydei fetched a random shirt and pants, tossing the jelly, disoriented deliverer toward his closet, muttering something about cover his neck.

He barely managed to dry himself as he ran toward the door.

Now

Hyacine took a sip of her drink, slow, watching without light in her eyes as the white-haired Alpha, now seated beside her, unwrapped the cloth around his neck. She didn’t scream. In fact, she didn’t make a sound at all. Just took another sip of the drink Mydei had been kind enough to put together

in his half-dead state. Was it even possible to look that dead while being called the undying crown prince? What was she even questioning. She was just so tired herself.

The healer continued to simply observed the gruesome display of bruises and marks spreading across the neck before her.

Then she wordlessly gulped down her juice as the two Alphas in the room started to panic at the passing silence. The Omega hadn't said a word after Phainon revealed his abused neck.

Phainon glanced at Mydei. So did the prince glance back at him.

But neither of them could explain.

Then,

"Did you guys… fight?" A tiny voice broke the silence. She shouldn't make assumptions. She shouldn't. But it was better to guess the safest route than hear whatever stored truth.

And the two Alphas let out a breath they didn't know they'd been holding. "No, it's just—" both of them said.

"You—"
"Hks—"

Now it was just the two glaring at each other.

Hyacine patiently took another sip of her drink, blankly staring.

Mydei seemed to struggle with words, looking around the room. Sitting somewhat pressed obnoxiously close behind Phainon—which neither of them seemed to realize. And Hyacine chose not to comment on it.

Finally, he seemed to find his thoughts and tiredly began explaining the events from the morning, starting with Phainon waking up. And Phainon just dumbly sat between the two, listening as Mydei trailed through the story, deliberately skimming over things, leaving gaps, but Phainon waited until he finished.

"Then this idiot went to the bath by himself, which I didn't think much of since he was talking just fine—" Mydei only rolled his eyes when the other stepped on his toe, then sighed deeply. "You were right, Hyacine. He did react badly."

That made Hyacine more worried as she asked for more details. And Phainon just looked confused as to why they seemed to know so much about this when he didn't. Like—why was he left out? Both Hyacine and Mydei exchanged more details about how Phainon had reacted, ignoring the Alpha altogether as if he wasn't literally the topic of conversation. As if he wasn't present in the room at all.

And when they just kept going on and on about how and what *Phainon* had done, so loudly that when he tried to talk they brushed him off, Hyacine noting everything down—

So clearly he also wanted to know what had happened.

“What happens to *me*?” he asked, almost uncharacteristically growling. He couldn’t stop himself either—his thoughts and instincts were still all over the place. He was confused and embarrassed.

He managed to interrupt both of them.

That made the two stop, shutting their mouths dead in their tracks. Mostly Mydei, who looked like he’d forgotten to explain the most important thing in the whole conversation. And Hyacine, who only looked at him in confusion.

“Wait—you haven’t told him yet?” Hyacine asked Mydei.

Phainon could feel Mydei shift beside him, almost uncomfortably. And though faint, he caught the whiff of distress in the Alpha’s scent.

Mydei sighed again. “Didn’t get the chance to properly explain,” he muttered, managing to gesture toward what had happened in the morning—mainly the breakdown. And *nothing else*. Well, not yet.

Phainon looked over to Hyacine, almost pleading for an explanation.

Her eyes widened, but she kindly nodded in understanding. Then she waited for Mydei’s approval. When the kremnoen Alpha finally nodded, she switched her attention back to the confused Deliverer before her.

Calmly as she could, she asked,

“Lord Phainon, what do you remember last?”

Though his memory was a bit mushy, now that Phainon actually tried to recall, he thought back. He remembered before waking up here was… an uneventful day. And—right. He remembered Mydei asking him for a spar. He remembered sparring, but the rest was hard to piece together.

He furrowed his brows. “I—I think I remember sparring with Mydei, but I can’t quite remember the rest.”

Hyacine nodded, and Mydei shuffled a bit farther from where he’d been pressed up against him. Phainon had to refuse the urge to slide back into the warmth.

Hyacine said calmly and carefully,

“During the spar… there was an accident.”

Phainon blinked, worry flickering. “Accident? What—you mean I hit my head or something?” That would make sense. It wasn’t the first time. Usually he’d wake up bandaged in the infirmary after knocking himself out, or after Mydei floored him too hard. Nothing new. “Because that happens all the time.”

Hyacine shook her head slowly. She glanced at Mydei, then back at him. “Not exactly. Try to recall. Do you remember how you two fought?”

Phainon frowned, trying to dig into the fog. *How we fought*… He closed his eyes, replaying scraps.

“I think… I remember drawing Dawnmaker,” he muttered. “And then—” A sharper image cut through. He saw himself moving fast, faster than he thought possible. He remembered Mydei pinned to the ground under him, his own breath heavy, the heat of it too close.

Behind him, he could feel Mydei tense up. The Alpha’s scent was shifting, distressed, the longer he spoke.

“And then…” Phainon’s voice dropped, almost without him meaning to. His hand twitched. “I remember you—ripping off my choker.”

Almost automatically, his fingers rose, brushing against the bare skin of his neck were the cloth had been. *Was he furious about a mark Mydei had left?*

Hyacine seemed to catch the misunderstanding immediately, she was quick to jump in.

“Lord Phainon, please calm down,” she reassured. “*That* mark was not from Lord Mydei.”

Now Phainon made a more distressed noise, confused.

And Mydei, catching the panic, huffed. “No…” quick to say, “Hyacine, I—I had marked him again —”

Hyacine blinked.

And blinked again.

Then mouthed an “oh.”

“I—what—”

Phainon turned toward Mydei, then back to Hyacine.

Hyacine nodded. “That’s right, Lord Phainon. You… dropped to your alpha subspace,” she said carefully, almost conflicted to say it out loud.

Phainon stared at her. “… how did I react?”

Hyacine’s eyes flicked to Mydei, then back. “Not violently. You were more… confused. Behaved, mostly.” She hesitated, choosing her words, clearly avoiding another one.

Behaved? Phainon didn’t know whether that was supposed to make him feel better or worse.

“And Lord Mydei…” she continued softly, “he felt bad about it.”

Phainon turned back to look at the Alpha beside him, searching his features. But Mydei only looked away, his jaw tight.

Hyacine filled the silence. “He chose to take care of you.”

To that, Phainon’s face warmed instantly. His chest too, despite himself. The thought of Mydei like that—watching over him, staying even when it must’ve been unbearable—was… warm. *Too warm.*

He dropped his gaze, flushing. He didn’t like it. He didn’t hate it either. Just… didn’t know what to do with the way it made him feel.

Silence stretched between them. Mydei still refused to look at him.

Then Hyacine finally spoke, a little awkward. “And… your injuries. The handprint on your neck. Does it hurt?”

Phainon blinked. “What?” He reached up, fingers brushing his skin. Oh. That. “Oh, no. I don’t even feel it.”

Hyacine nodded, turning back to her bag. She started digging for something, muttering under her breath—probably ointment.

Phainon stopped her. “Wait.” His voice came out smaller than he wanted. “I… don’t want it gone.”

The words hung there, heavy. Embarrassing. He felt his face heat instantly, ears burning. *Idiot. Why would you say that out loud.*

Mydei’s head turned—just slightly. A quick glance. But it was enough.

Hyacine froze. Then furrowed, staring at him like she finally understood. She exhaled sharply. “Alphas…” she muttered under her breath, shaking her head.

After chatting for sometime Hyacine finally decided to change her attention to the other Alpha in the room. She needed to inspect Mydei. The Alpha looked worse than she’d seen him before. Though he was good at hiding it.

“Lord Mydei… how are you?” Hyacine asked.

That made Phainon glance at him too. Hyacine stood and moved closer, reaching out like she meant to examine the Alpha.

“It’s nothing,” Mydei muttered, pulling back just enough to make it sound stubborn.

But her hand brushed against his arm, and she froze. The heat under her palm wasn’t normal. Her eyes narrowed.

“…you’re burning up,” she said quietly.

Phainon's eyes widened, swelling with realization.

Mydei only pressed his lips together, gaze sliding away, refusing to meet either of their eyes.

Hyacine's worry spiked instantly. "Lord Mydei—" She cut herself short, frowning deeper as she really looked at him.

He looked almost normal. Calm. Steady. Like always. But now that she was paying attention, it was obvious—the faint flush on his face wasn't embarrassment. His skin was too hot, his breathing a little uneven. He had been hiding it well the whole time.

Before he could move, Hyacine reached up and pressed her palm against his forehead.

"Lord Mydei," she murmured, worried and slightly shocked.

"Why do you have a fever?"

Chapter End Notes

Hyacine saying Phainon was well behaved in his subspace—pfft girl you forgot to mention the part where he also mauled someone onto the ground…well behaved sure…

There's still stuff to discuss lol Phainon had missed out a lot but don't worry he's gonna get hit by it all soon.

Mydei dealing with some consequences from before he kept it good but symptoms are here!

Anyhow

Writting sub Phai is somthing(in smut), I mean I did write a fic dedicated sub Phai—why am I even surprised. (But it was supposed to be craaack!)

GUYS this is what happens when y'all tempt me to write smut!

They literally skipped the feelings part so fast…(mainly ignoring) Blame it on their freak4freak agenda—not me

And free will!

Also our poor girl Hyacine must've lived outside in a different time zone bc how does one explain how fast they did what they did in that shower scene—must be Orynix's miracle huh!

Cries as my wholesome crack fic becomes yaoi gooning noooo I'm falling back to my evil roots

I survived for 6 whole chapters what happens to me

Anyways two more chapters left!

I’m about to make everything worse

Yeah we ain’t getting a cute finale—

Ty for reading! Kudos!

laughs and runs away

Chapter 9: Consequences

Chapter Summary

Actions can lead to consequences~

Chapter Notes

Hello!!!!!

Happy New Year GUYS!! Omg this was supposed to uploaded before new year I simply wasn't satisfied with the chapter so it took too long.

And also my friend who suggested this promt, sent me this fan art of a scene from chapter 1 drawn by a artist from X.

The Artist is @X/robbu_k9 pls check out their arts! They are amazing! 😭❤️ Here
I'm not that active twitter(my personal acc) I'm so sorry I couldn't thank you there! and I'm sure most of the new comers came from X. (My email flooded with so many kudos and comments so suddenly I had a mini panic attack lol)

The art omg! Thank you robb! I'm happy you enjoyed my silly fic! it's mostly self indulgent (obviously) and I'm happy everyone under their comments enjoyed this too and was so nice I literally started tearing up. Really the fic is a silly result of my adhd writing lmao

I apologize for the long wait, I went thru some shit in life so yea… typical excuse—I got writers block. And had a horrible time sticking to one fic idea. I was like writing different AUs one after another I couldn't really focus on one. So sorry about that!

▶ **About the Fic's Timeline : (please read)**

Don't really think about canon timeline shit haha!

Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

—— ✧ ・ ／／

“Will you kill me too, Khaslana”

—— ✧ ・ ⸝⸝

Phainon stared down at the body lying on the bed.

It barely looked like a person anymore.

Bandages wrapped him from throat to torso, layered thick and tight, some already darkened where blood had seeped through. Wires ran beneath the wrappings, disappearing into skin and muscle, feeding into softly humming machines stationed around the bed. A monitor hovered close, its steady pulse the only proof the man hadn’t slipped away yet.

Hyacine was with him, explaining further what had happened. He hummed occasionally, processing it all.

Phainon noticed she hadn’t moved from his side the entire time. Close enough that her sleeve brushed his arm when she gestured. Like she was either anchoring him or afraid of another outburst. It must have been both—he could tell.

His eyes stayed fixed on the slow rise and fall of the man’s chest.

I did this.

The thought lodged deep, heavy and sour.

After examining both him and Mydei, Hyacine had asked them to come to the courtyard. She said she wanted to look at them more. She wrapped his neck with some bandages, hoping it would cover everything. Then she started explaining more on the way—how everything had pretty much gotten out of hand recently. How they were dealing with this potentially devastating threat. A drug, she had said. Illegally sold and spreading.

Mydei barely spoke or added anything. He walked with them in silence, gaze fixed ahead but distant, like he was following out of guidance rather than awareness. His steps were steady, but his mind was clearly somewhere else. Even Phainon felt anxious seeing him in such a state.

Phainon saw small things—Hyacine’s concerning furrow when she examined Mydei’s temperature, the way she took him aside to discuss something privately. He didn’t mind. He truly didn’t. But a faint itch still settled in his chest. Like they were treating him like broken glass. Or as if he was incapable of hearing it himself.

Still, he didn’t let it get to him.

He waited politely until their conversation was over, until they set off toward the courtyard. On the road,

Hyacine told him about what he had done. What he had done to a another Alpha

She ofcouse didn’t hesitate to say it was for the best, that his reaction was completely understandable. Phainon didn’t comment much. He only said what needed to be said—that he would take full responsibility.

Hyacine told him again and again that it was a good thing they had caught the suspect. The man had slipped past even Cipher. A Kremnoen whom Mydei didn't recognize much at all.

Even if the way it was done was brutal, Hyacine said, the suspect deserved it. The man was a murderer—or at least tied to several civilian deaths. Omegas mostly. Some were even Alphas.

Eventually, they ended up here.

Just him and Hyacine.

Mydei had been escorted somewhere else. Phainon wasn't told why, but he understood it must have been important.

Now, standing at the foot of the bed, the weight of it all finally settled.

A deep, sinking feeling curled in his stomach when he looked at the man again. Even after Hyacine had assured him countless times. And Phainon knew her well enough to hear the truth beneath it.

She didn't choose sides. She never had. She was just being a healer. Just being a *friend*.

He knew that as a healer she would never choose. Even if someone was cruel, even if they were a monster—if it was possible, she would try. She stood between fault and forgiveness and tended to whatever was left behind.

That's who she is, he thought. *That's who she's always been.*

Hyacine placed a hand against Phainon's back. It was a gentle gesture.

"It wasn't your fault," she said again, smiling.

Phainon nodded as he smiled back, but it was strained.

Then she left.

The door slid shut, leaving him alone with the machines and the quiet.

Phainon was aware of the golden threads. They were everywhere. Coiled through the air, brushing against his shoulders, tightening subtly whenever he shifted.

Aglaea must be being careful. He couldn't quite tell if it was for him or the Alpha on the bed. For both, he guessed. She must have been worried. Maybe even disappointed by his behavior.

He knew now—his actions would most likely have consequences. And Aglaea's growing headache.

She must be dealing with his shit right now.

"I'm sorry, Aglaea," he whispered to himself.

When Phainon finally exited past the guarded door—past the two guards still stationed there like

sentinels—he found Hyacine already speaking with Cipher.

Cipher glanced at him once.

Just once.

Her tail flicked lazily behind her, the motion loose and unbothered, as if none of this concerned her in the slightest. Her expression was bright, relaxed—borderline amused. Uncaring in the way only someone who had already made up their mind could be.

“You pulled quite the stunt, boy,” she said casually. “Aggy already has her hands full, you know.”

She stretched, arms lifting above her head in an exaggerated motion, bones popping faintly. Then she turned fully toward him and clapped a hand against his back—hard enough that it jolted him forward a step.

“—But hey,” she added easily, grinning. “At least you got the brat.”

Phainon blinked.

Whatever response he might’ve had stalled somewhere in his throat. In the end, he only managed a wordless nod.

Cipher wasn’t done.

She leaned closer, squinting at his face, her ears twitching. “Zagreus’s big balls,” she muttered. “You look like a wet, soggy dog.”

Her nose wrinkled in clear distaste. “And I hate dogs.”

“Straighten up, boy!”

Then, just like that, she waved over her shoulder and shot off, already losing interest. “See ya.”

Phainon stood there for a second longer than necessary.

His brow furrowed as he lifted a hand to his face, smoothing it down reflexively, as if he could press whatever was showing back into place.

…Did he really look that obvious?

Beside him, Hyacine chuckled softly.

Eventually, The omega healer steers him away from the courtyard.

It isn’t abrupt. She doesn’t grab him or rush him along. Just a gentle redirection, a hand at his elbow, her steps angling deliberately toward the market streets instead. A change of scenery, intentional and obvious. Phainon doesn’t resist it.

He follows.

He lets her talk.

Lets her keep filling the space with words so there's no room for his thoughts to circle back inward, no silence for the echoes to catch in. He listens in the way one listens when they're trying not to drown—half-attentive, grateful for the noise.

They talk about the case Cipher had shared. More details this time. More fragments filling in the shape of something ugly. More victims than initially thought. More locations. More signs that whatever had started this hadn't stayed contained the way anyone had hoped.

How far it might have spread.

Phainon nods at the right moments, offers quiet responses where they're expected. He tries not to notice the way Hyacine keeps glancing at him from the corner of her eye, concern barely disguised behind her professional focus. He pretends he's simply watching the people around them instead—the vendors, the passersby, the shifting expressions when they recognize him.

He tells himself that's all it is.

The guilt settles deep in his gut, heavy and immovable. Worse than the guilt is the emptiness where memory should be. The blank space. The fact that everyone seems to know something about him that he doesn't. That there are consequences pressing in on all sides, and he can't even remember earning them. He's ashamed really. Of himself of what he did.

His quiet self-loathing must show more than he realizes, because—

"I'm hungry," Hyacine announced suddenly, looking toward the nearby stalls.

Little Ica, who had been entirely uninterested in the conversation up until now, perks up instantly. The small creature floats closer to Hyacine's shoulder, eyes bright, little form vibrating with excitement.

"Doot doot!"

Phainon lets out a soft huff of a laugh before he can stop himself. "Yeah," he says, voice lighter than he feels. "…me too."

They drift between the vendors after that, the crowd closing in around them. Hyacine points out a few options, asking if there's anything he wants, anything that catches his eye. Phainon just shrugs, noncommittal, hands tucked loosely at his sides.

He does his best not to notice the looks that follow him.

The way some people pause. The way others avert their gaze too quickly. The way a few stare, just a second longer than they should.

They settled on some snacks. Hyacine munched happily while Phainon swallowed his share more absentmindedly, his thoughts drifting. He found himself conflicted—should he buy something for Mydei?

He wanted to. He really did.

He wanted to give him something good. Somthing he'd like. The feeling felt warm in his chest.

They were almost nearing the end of the market when panic began to creep in. He still hadn't decided. Nervously, he scanned the stalls, trying not to look frantic—that's when Hyacine suddenly dashed off.

"Oh no."

Phainon turned just in time to see Little Ica attempting to inhale an entire stall. It sounded unnatural. But it was, unfortunately, exactly what was happening.

While he chuckled and waited, a stall caught his eye.

Golden honey cakes.

A sweet older woman was selling neatly packed boxes of them. Phainon's thoughts scattered immediately to Mydei.

The Alpha loved honey cakes.

Should he buy some?

Heat crept up his neck as he remembered everything that had happened. Would Mydei even accept a gift right now? Maybe as an apology? He had taken care of him through all of it. Been so patient. So steady.

His Alpha pawed insistently inside his chest.

Buy them.

It would be a good gift.

He should.

"Little Ica!" Hyacine yelped, trying to pry the creature away as it attempted to consume the entire display.

Phainon took the moment, stepping aside to quickly purchase a small box of honey cakes. He thanked the vendor and turned—

And then he heard it.

"—Isn't that Lord Phainon?"

His steps faltered.

"Well, looks like he's alright."

"Have you heard what he did?"

"Yeah. It's scary."

"They're really letting him walk around after—"

Phainon didn't stay to hear the rest.

He clutched the bag tighter and forced himself forward, stomach curling, heart suddenly hammering.

Behind him, Hyacine finally wrestled Little Ica free, bowing apologetically to the owner at the stall. The woman waved it off with a smile. Hyacine paid anyway.

When she rejoined him, Phainon smiled—small, practiced—as they fell into step toward the courtyard.

Hyacine peeked at the bag in his hand and smiled, nudging Little Ica back to her side as the creature eyed the box with interest.

“For Lord Mydei?” she asked despite knowing too well.

Phainon blinked, caught. He laughed softly, embarrassed, and nodded. “Yeah.”

Hyacine smiled at him.

“So Umm… Lord Phainon,” Hyacine had started while they entered the Couryard again, carefully, she waited a few beats to pass. Then,

“Is there anything related to your childhood… about bite marks?”

Phainon paused, his brow furrowing. “What do you mean?”

Hyacine hesitated. “Nothing. It’s just—I saw something recently and it’s…” Then she reached for her teleslate and turned it toward him. An article bloomed across the screen—an image of a chained man snarling at the camera, eyes wild.

Alpha Subspaces — Are They Truly What You Think They Are? Are You Safe?

Phainon stared at it, puzzled.

Is this… related?

But then his thoughts spiraled—too fast, too sharp. He suddenly remembered the odd looks, the way some people glanced away or subtly kept their distance. *Was that it? Were they afraid of him?*

Hyacine seemed to sense the shift immediately and pulled the teleslate back, almost too quickly.

“It’s—it’s nothing serious,” she rushed, waving her hands uselessly. “Really. I don’t usually read this kind of junk. But your case is… new. So I did skim it.”

She explained how the article talked about Alpha Subspaces and how they worked. But one particular detail had caught her eye. After interviewing several Alphas, it had come to light that most Subspaces were connected to certain events in their lives. Most of them harmless. But some… could be traced back to trauma.

Phainon was caught off guard, thinking deeper about her words.

“Is there a particular moment you could remember?” Hyacine asked, curious.

Phainon's eyes misted despite himself.

Aedes Elysiae, his mind supplied.

"My childhood, huh…"

Well, it wasn't a secret after all. He had mostly good memories there. Happy ones. Running around with friends. The sea… the wheat fields. Dreaming about being heroes. Getting into trouble. Being scolded by his parents.

To the *unfortunate—*

The Black Tide. How his village got swallowed whole by it. Its slow corruption. How no one knew. No one was prepared.

Their peaceful village swarmed by monsters. How his family, his friends, his kin all turned into those monsters.

The day he was presented as an Alpha. Just a teenager.

A sword in his hands.

Blood.

Defending himself.

Slaughtering his own village—

"Lord Phainon!"

Hyacine's sharp call cut through his thoughts. She was staring up at him now, eyes wide with alarm. He realized distantly that his scent had soured, thick in the air. His own hand had hovered at his neck.

"Apologies," he said quickly, forcing a small smile as he lowered it. "I didn't mean to space out like that. I—" His voice was a bit shaky. He ignored the tension curling in his chest. "Could you repeat the question?"

Hyacine puffed her cheeks, half-annoyed, half-worried. "I asked if you have any memories of past bite marks. Any particular event."

Not that he thought deeply into it. Ever since he came to Okhema as a child, most of his childhood memories got buried with the burdens of the Flame Chase. He simply forgot. He thinks. But then

again, if he could recall… He thought of Aglaea then—because there were moments when Aglaea's threads hovered around him like a hawk. He didn't think much of it, how she always went quiet whenever he was bruised or marked. How she watched him too closely in those moments, like she knew something he didn't. He had always assumed it was worry. About the Flame Chase. About what he was being shaped into.

Favoritism, others called it.

But it had never felt like that.

"I can't think of anything," Phainon said at last. "Not right now." He tilted his head slightly. "Why do you ask?"

Hyacine hummed, rubbing her chin, then nodded to herself. "Nothing serious," she said. "Tell me if there's anything." "I'm researching about these stuff now," she added proudly. "Your case was unique."

Phainon felt confused again. *Was it that bad? How bad did he act?*

"I'll keep that in mind."

When they finally reached the courtyard—when they were close enough that Phainon could feel where Mydei was supposed to be—Hyacine was suddenly asked away for a moment. Someone called her name from the side, urgent but hushed.

She hesitated, then turned to Phainon. "Go on without me," she said quickly. "I'll join you. Just—wait for me, alright?"

Phainon nodded, even though his attention had already drifted forward.

He took a deep breath as he walked, clutching the box closer to his chest than necessary. Anticipation curled tight in his stomach. He and Mydei hadn't really had a proper chance to sit down and talk—everything had gone from zero to a million far too quickly earlier today. No pause. No space to understand. Just impact after impact.

He kept walking, ignoring the glances thrown his way. He could feel them anyway.

A guard stood in front of Mydei's private room.

That alone made him slow.

It was a room reserved for Chrysos Heirs when they were injured—protected, yes, but never sealed off like this. Phainon frowned, confusion knitting between his brows. Why add security here, of all places? But then again, with everything that had happened recently, maybe they were being careful. Maybe this was normal now.

He didn't like that thought.

He was halted immediately.

Phainon lifted his gaze to the man in question. The guard straightened, then bowed slightly.

“I apologize, Lord Phainon,” the guard said carefully, “but Lord Mydei has strictly prohibited anyone from entering.”

“Why?”

The word came out sharper than he intended. Irritation had crawled up his chest, sudden and hot. All he wanted to do was push past the guard and enter. Mydei had been so out of it earlier—clearly struggling, clearly not okay. He had to be fighting all of that alone right now. Phainon should be in there, comforting him, grounding him—not standing here wasting time.

But then again—Those thoughts felt too instinctive.

Too immediate.

That realization made him hesitate, just barely. His impulses still felt too close to the surface. He didn’t want to add another misunderstanding on top of the one he was already drowning in.

He tried to calm himself.

Tried to compose himself.

It might’ve been too late.

Because the guard was already stepping aside.

Phainon couldn’t tell if it was because of his scent—or the expression he hadn’t realized he was making.

“I’m just doing my job, my lord,” the guard said shakily, even as he moved out of the way.

Phainon exhaled slowly, then shook his head.

“No—don’t worry,” he said, forcing something like a smile. “I’m just here to see him. A small conversation. Nothing more.”

The guard hesitantly nods, and as the man steps aside to let Phainon in, he hears another sound coming from inside. Something falling down—then a woman’s shriek.

Phainon immediately pushes the door open.

The scent hits him immediately—sandalwood, thick and overwhelming, pressed into the air like a physical force. It’s too much. For a split second his knees threaten to buckle, instinct screaming to pull him forward, to close the distance, to anchor.

He straightens instead. It would be humiliating to lurch toward Mydei like that. Entirely out of character. And frankly, no one here needed to witness that.

That aside—

Mydei is standing beside the bed.

There is also someone else in the room. A woman with dark hair is crouched near his feet, trembling violently. A beta attendant. Her eyes are wide, her breath shallow like she's just barely keeping herself together. A tray lies overturned beside her, porcelain shattered across the floor.

"Get outta here," the Alpha snarls.

The sound makes Phainon wince.

Mydei's voice is rough—scraped raw, like his throat is too dry. It hurts to hear. Worse, it sounds like it hurts to say.

Mydei's hands are clenched around the bedpost, knuckles white, his entire body shaking as if restraint is the only thing keeping him upright. He looks mad in a way Phainon has never seen before. Like he might lunge at anyone still breathing in the room.

How bad did it have to get for this to happen?

The woman scrambles to her feet and bolts for the door, nearly colliding with Phainon as she passes. She doesn't look at him. Doesn't slow. Just escapes.

Only then does Mydei finally register Phainon's presence.

He turns,

And—*He's in pain.*

That's the first thing Phainon sees. Not anger. It was pain, pain pulled tight beneath skin, barely contained. Every part of him is tense, coiled, like he's fighting something internal with everything he has.

And then Phainon sees it.

Fear

Real, naked fear in the eyes of the Kremnoen prince.

It knocks the breath out of him.

Mydei's chest rises and falls too fast. Sweat darkens his temples. His face is flushed, eyes hazy, tinged red-gold like he's on the edge of losing himself. He looks like he's barely holding it together.

Somewhere inside Phainon's chest, his Alpha is loud. His inner thoughts are loud. A part of him wants to go near him, scent him, calm him down. But another side stands its ground—a side that is scared that if he moved, something really bad is going to happen. Something he couldn't control.

It had happened before.

And he doesn't even remember that.

His mind spirals through all the possibilities. The mark on his neck was still strong. He wouldn't be able to control himself with Mydei's scent even if he tried. Though he hadn't been since he woke

up. What would change if he does right now?

Even so, his body shifts without conscious thought, subtly placing himself between Mydei and the guard hovering anxiously at the door.

He doesn't want to leave him like this.

After everything.

Is leaving really the right choice?

Mydei finally meets his eyes—and for a fraction of a second, something devastating flashes across his face.

Helplessness.

Then it's gone, swallowed by anger. His jaw tightens. His eyes harden.

He looks away.

And there's a pathetic part of Phainon that aches for him to look back.

"Get out," Mydei snaps, voice hoarse. "I said no visitors."

Phainon hesitates. "Mydei…"

He can't turn away. Not now.

"You shouldn't be here," Mydei says.

Phainon takes a step forward. something stubborn and competitive stirring in his chest. "I know that"

That somehow gets his attention.

Mydei turns sharply—and for a split second, something raw flashes across his face. Not relief. Not want.

Irritation.

Phainon's Alpha stiffens immediately, alert and uneasy.

He's hurt, it whispers. *We should—*

"You shouldn't be here," Mydei repeats flatly as he sits on the bed. The movement costs him. Phainon sees it in the way his fingers dig into the stone frame again. "Didn't the guard stop you?"

"He *tried*." The white haired alpha tries to joke.

"That wasn't an invitation."

Phainon feels heat creep up his neck. Embarrassed.

"I just wanted to check on you."

There’s a beat.

Then Mydei laughs—short, humorless. “That’s rich.”

Phainon tilts his head, frowning. He catches the wrong signal entirely.

“You’re displeased.”

“What do you think?” Mydei snaps, breath heavy. “You don’t get to hover around like this after—after everything turned into a mess.”

Silence crashes down between them.

The guard retreats quietly, closing the door behind him. Their scents clash violently in the enclosed space, thick enough to choke on.

It was a mess. Phainon can’t deny that.

Everything is a mess.

He doesn’t understand any of it—his part, the things he’s done, the way his relationship with Mydei has shifted without a memory to anchor him. Everyone keeps telling him things, assuming things, expecting him to know. He just didn’t fully understand any of it. He tried. Tried to understand everything. To process it all. Yet*Everything*—it was all too much.

And Mydei looked scared. Shaken.

Scared of something neither of them are naming.

Leaving now would be sensible. Mydei clearly wants him gone. He looks to be dealing somthing of his own. Staying will only make it worse.

But he can’t make himself walk away.

“Hyacine said you were—”

“I don’t care what Hyacine said.”

Phainon stiffens.

There it is.

Embarrassment crawls up his spine. He’s clinging now. He was finding excuses to stay here. To see Mydei.

What he really wanted was—

“I just wanted to see if you were alright.”

There’s a pause. Mydei grips the edge of the bed harder. Then a humorless breath leaves alpha’s nose.

“And what exactly were you planning to do if I wasn’t?”

Something about those words makes him want to leave.

Mydei was mocking him. As if he thinks Phainon is incapable of handling the situation right. Maybe he was. He doesn't know. He doesn't want to come up with that conclusion yet.

"What's that supposed to mean?" he asks anyway, not wanting say what he actually wants to say, ignoring the way his capabilities are being mocked right now. Ignoring how he's viewed as some stranger.

Mydei doesn't react at all.

And that shouldn't hurt the way it does now.

Instead, the Kremnoen shakes his head.

"Don't sound so incompetent."

Phainon straightens reflexively, trying to calm his racing heart. He felt hopeless.

"That's not fair."

"No," Mydei says, voice low. "What's not fair is you walking in here like this is… normal."

Phainon's brows knit. He wants to argue. It was not normal. He's just as confused as to why everything turned out like this.

"Like what is normal?"

Mydei looks away.

That's worse.

Phainon can feel his own Alpha crawl back.

He doesn't want us to see.

To see him like this.

Mydei despite the struggles reflectively still picks out his soured scent.

"I'm not myself right now," he says finally. "And I don't trust what I might do."

Phainon blinks. "Do to who?"

Mydei's jaw tightens. He doesn't answer.

The silence answers for him.

Phainon exhales slowly. "You think I can't handle you?"

"I think," Mydei snaps, then reins it in with visible effort, "that you shouldn't have to."

Phainon's pride flares—hot and defensive. Why can't Mydei just accept his help. He doesn't have to go through whatever this is alone.

“That’s not your decision.”

Mydei laughs at that, softly, bitter. “Isn’t it?”

Something in Phainon falters.

“You’re not making sense.”

“I am,” Mydei says, turning back to him now, eyes fever-bright. “You just don’t like what it implies.”

He doesn’t trust us.

His inner Alpha leans forward, listening too closely. They want to fix it.

Say it.

Phainon lifts the small box in his hands, suddenly self-conscious.

“I brought you something. Just—”

Mydei’s gaze drops to it. His expression twists.

“…Get out.”

His inner Alpha recoils violently.

He rejects it.

Phainon’s fingers curl around the box, ignoring the annoying voice.

“It’s just food.”

“It’s not about the food,” Mydei says sharply. He drags a hand down his face, breath suddenly uneven. “You don’t get to act like all this is fine.”

Why

Phainon’s voice tightens. “Then tell me what it is.”

Mydei hesitates.

That hesitation is everything.

“I feel things I shouldn’t,” Mydei says at last. “And you’re making it worse.”

Phainon himself does too. But does Mydei hates it?

Phainon straightens instinctively. No, that can’t just be it. Mydei is pushing his buttons on purpose. Phainon reminds himself, *He is making a scene so I would leave*

“I can handle you, Mydei,” he says, taking a step closer—and Mydei visibly flinches. And all Phainon wants to calm the Alpha down. Everything inside him wants to do that.

“We are equals, remember,” he says carefully. Because they are. Nothing should’ve changed between them. Phainon needs to make this right. “You said so, yourself—”

But Mydei laughs again, cutting him off—bitter this time.

“Are we?”

Phainon can feel his inner Alpha freeze. While all he did was stare. “…What do you mean?”

Had what happened between them really changed that?

“It means,” Mydei says, shaking by the second, trying to stay calm, “that lately I don’t recognize the way you look at me.”

Phainon’s breath catches.

He is lying, he is trying to make you leave. He reminds himself again.

“I look at you the same way I always have.”

“No,” Mydei snaps. “You look at me like—”

Like what.

Phainon wants to ask. *What changed.*

Mydei growls as he turns away, his hand curling into the sheets.

“Out.”

Phainon still hestitates.

And Mydei doesn’t like that. **“I said Get out.”**

Phainon takes a hesitant step back then he nods absently. The mark on his neck burns. “Fine,” he says, trying to keep his composure in check. The word tastes like ash.

He really doesn’t want to leave. He wanted to stay. He wants to show him he cared too. That somehow all of this wasn’t just…instincts? And it’s obvious Mydei is just trying to make him leave. Whatever Mydei was suppressing, Mydei didn’t trust him enough to understand.

And it hurts too.

It also irritates him.

As if he isn’t capable…

He sets the box of honey cakes down on the table with more force than necessary. Watching Mydei doesn’t do much but flinch at that. Uncared.

“For what it’s worth, I never meant to make things worse.”

Mydei doesn’t look at him.

“Intent doesn’t erase consequence.”

And Phainon hums. He understands, distantly, that whatever they did—*he did*—whatever he was—must’ve been too much.

He stares at Mydei’s back for a few seconds before leaving.

Part of him hates how he accepted defeat so early. That he let Mydei have his way.

The other part is confused.

Of how Mydei viewed him now.

Had he actually meant that…?

Had he looked at Phainon—at his subspace—and seen it as a weakness? Had he decided that Phainon himself was weak? That he wasn’t worthy enough to stand by his side anymore?

That the way he had acted—instinctive, confused, reaching—was it something to be ashamed...

The thought settled heavy in his chest, refusing to move.

“See you later, Mydeimos.”

The words left his mouth quietly. Almost carefully.

He didn’t get a reply.

Phainon turned away before he could linger on it any longer.

He finally walked outside in defeat. The door shut behind him with a sound that felt far too final. The guard watched him go, silent, offering no judgment, no comfort, no nothing at all.

There was an itch on his neck. Right over his bandaged mark. Which made his fingers twitch, aching to claw at it, to do something with the sensation instead of letting it sit there and burn. But he didn’t touch it. He just kept walking.

His inner Alpha had gone surprisingly quiet too.

That was what unsettled him a bit.

It was strange—now—considering how loud his mind had been just a few hours back. The instincts that had screamed and clawed and pushed were gone now, gone quiet.

On his way down the corridor, he spotted Hyacine moving quickly toward him.

She looked panicked.

Her steps faltered when she saw him, eyes widening as if something horrible had already happened—or was about to. She opened her mouth, clearly about to say something urgent.

“Phainon—” she starts.

But she doesn’t finish.

Footsteps rush past her, abrupt and loud. Guards move between them, cutting her off before she can take another step. She falters, turning slightly as they pass, hand lifting halfway like she might reach for him—but she stops.

They surround him just outside the corridor, steel closing in from all sides. More than five of them. Spears lifted, tips glinting as they level them toward his chest, his throat, anywhere they're can aim.

Phainon doesn't flinch.

If anything, he feels strangely calm.

Hyacine stops short a few steps away, her breath catching. One hand flies up to her mouth, fingers trembling as her eyes widen in disbelief.

Phainon's gaze settles on the man standing directly in front of him.

He had expected this.

He just hadn't expected it to come this early.

"Chrysos Heir, Phainon of Aedes Elysiae," he announces. "By order of the Council of Elders, you are to come with us."

—✧・⁄⁄

"Phainon! Look—look!"

A voice cuts through Phainon's peaceful sleep, bright and airy. A hand shakes him by the shoulder where he's stretched out in the grass, eyes half-closed, the world slow and drowsy around him. Phainon groans softly and cracks one eye open.

Livia is grinning down at him, proud of something.

"Look," she says again, thrusting her wrist toward his face.

Phainon blinks, then pushes himself up onto his elbows, squinting. There's a small plaster wrapped neatly around her wrist.

His brow furrows immediately. Worried. "What happened?"

"Hehe—don't worry!" Livia waves it off quickly. "I was helping the professor."

“Oh,” Phainon says. Then he glances around, now relaxed. “Where’s Piso?”

Livia shrugs, unbothered, still examining her bandaged wrist like it’s something precious. “Don’t know. I saw him with the professor last.”

That makes Phainon look toward the cluster of houses nearby, thoughtful. “Where is *he* now?”

“In his place,” Livia says easily. “I think.”

Phainon hums under his breath and pushes himself to his feet, brushing grass off his clothes. Livia barely notices as he wanders off, already distracted by something else entirely.

The said ‘professor’s’ house is small, like most in the village. Stone walls warmed by the sun. Whitewashed surfaces chipped with age. Open windows that let the breeze roll through, carrying the faint scent of herbs, metal, and something sharper underneath.

Inside, it’s a whole other mess. Shelves crowded with jars and vials. Bundles of dried plants hanging from the ceiling beams. Tables scarred with old burn marks and ink stains. It’s improvised, lived-in, quietly busy.

Phainon slips inside secretly.

The boy spots the person he is looking for immediately—a mess of brown hair bent forward as the man hunches over a table, papers spread messily beneath his hands. The professor looks deep in thought, his red eyes narrowed, fingers stained faintly with ink or dried blood.

Phainon grins to himself and tries to sneak closer. He tiptoes past a low stool, peeking over glass test tubes arranged near the table—only to nearly knock into a chair. It scrapes softly against the floor.

“Careful.”

Phainon freezes.

He looks up just in time to see the man glancing over his shoulder, amused.

Caught.

Phainon pouts exaggeratedly, arms crossing over his chest. “You noticed.”

The man—with brown hair chuckles softly and straightens, turning fully now. “I did.” He gestures with two fingers. “Come closer.”

Phainon hesitates only a second before obeying, curiosity winning out. He pads over and settles at their new village physician’s side, leaning over the table, eyes scanning the papers.

And ofcouse none of it makes sense.

He makes a face.

The doctor laughs again. “Confused?”

Phainon squints. “Is that Livia’s blood?”

“Yes,” Older man answers easily. “For my research.”

“What kind?” Phainon asks, tilting his head. He’s seen the professor do all kinds of research—mostly around his friends. Ever since this stranger appeared, he had been helping around their village, he’d somehow charmed everyone here. Patching the injured, tending the ill. Children hovered around his house constantly, drawn in by curiosity and kindness alike.

The doctor taps the page lightly. “Unpresented children,” he murmurs. “I’m trying to see something.” Then, almost dismissively, already knowing the boy wouldn’t understand a word of it.

“Oh,” Phainon says, immediately brightening. He suddenly shoves his hand forward, palm up. “Then you can take mine too!”

The medic stills.

For just a moment.

His gaze shifts, settling fully on the boy now—round cheeks still warm from the sun, white hair catching the light, eyes bright and eager, smiling so openly it borders on reckless.

Then he shakes his head and reaches out, ruffling Phainon’s hair gently. The hand stays there a bit longer than necessary.

“No,” he says, smiling. His hand trails down, hovering over the sun mark on the boy’s neck, barely touching it. Phainon watches in quiet curiosity as the hand retreats. “Not yours.”

“Why” The whites haired boy pouts.

“Because your blood is unique.”

Phainon beams immediately, oblivious to everything else. “It is?”

“Yes,” the doctor replies calmly. “I wouldn’t want it…” He takes the boy’s hand, caressing it carefully, thumb brushing over his palm “…wasted.”

Phainon frowns, lips pursing. He never gets to help the kind gentleman. “But I want to help you too, Professor Zan—”

The man doesn’t let him finish. He flicks the boy’s forehead lightly.

Phainon yelps, clutching his head, cheeks puffed. “Hey!”

“What did I just say”

The older man returns his attention to the papers, hunching over them once more. Phainon follows his gaze instinctively, peering down at the strange symbols and notes. The ‘scientist’ smiles faintly to himself, something already turning over in his mind. He ignores the pouty teen.

“Your already helping me,” he says.

“By existing, Khaslana.”

Chapter End Notes

Um Happy New Year…?! Hope you guys have a wonderful year ahead! Hehe

And as promised I made everything worse…
…

..

.

Pls forgive me I'm about to(already did)make up some bullshit lore up, because who let me cook…let's spice up the drama shall we!

but dw I'm just tweaking the canon backstory for shit and giggles nothing too serious to think about, don't worry about Phainon he's totally *fine.*

And Mydei… give this man an award for being the embodiment of restraint and not lashing out by now. Next chapter will probably be his problems, since I already gave a big cake for Phainon and now it's his turn…I may or maybe not tweak his backstory too. Because I'm that crazy… but hopefully it will all turn out okey! I hope!

The story felt borning without our lovely Lygussy and Caenis(bish) but hey they still be haunting am I right?! And for Cyrene idk I'm conflicted to add her or not…

Anyhow really, don't really mind the plot(it's not really important) it's just there paving it's way so we somehow gets some action(wink wink) and drama down there.

Anyways bye! Hopefully next chapter want take so long *begging this year to be kinder to me*

Cya and tc!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!